ENGLISH COURSE · LEVEL 4 · B1+ · 12 WEEKS · 30 MINUTES A DAY

English Course Level 4: Intermediate

المستوى الرابع: اتكلم براحتك في أي موقف

Talk about what might have been, what will be, and the world around you — clearly and confidently.

اتكلم إنجليزي براحتك في الشغل والسفر والنقاش، من غير ما تقف عند كل جملة.

360 words | 120 key sentences | 12 grammar points | 48 exercises + answers | 3 progress checks

Mohamed Abdelkriem · English Course · Level 4 (B1+)

How to Use This Course

This book is all you need for the next 3 months. Every day has a clear job. Do 30 minutes, 6 days a week, and on day 7 just enjoy a story or a video. Don't skip days — 30 minutes every day is better than 3 hours once a week.

الكتاب ده هو كل اللي محتاجه في الـ٣ شهور الجايين. ذاكر ٣٠ دقيقة في اليوم، ٦ أيام في الأسبوع، واليوم السابع استمتع بقصة أو فيديو بالإنجليزي.

Who is this level for?

المستوى ده لكل اللي خلّص المستوى التالت (B1) وعايز ينقل كلامه لمستوى أعلى. في ١٢ أسبوع هتتعلم ٣٦٠ كلمة وتعبير جديد و١٢٠ جملة، وأهم قواعد المستوى المتوسط زي الشرط التالت وwish والأفعال الناقلة والـphrasal verbs. وفي الآخر هتقدر تناقش وتشتكي وتكتب إيميل رسمي ومقال رأي من ١٥٠ لـ٢٠٠ كلمة، وتفهم حلقات BBC وTED-Ed من غير ترجمة.

After this level you can...

- After this level you can talk about past decisions and regrets, and imagine how things could have been different.
- After this level you can make a complaint politely and firmly, by email or on the phone.
- After this level you can report what people said, promised, suggested or denied.
- After this level you can make predictions and plans with the future continuous and the future perfect.
- After this level you can discuss the news, health, education and global issues, and compare ideas clearly.
- After this level you can write emails, reviews, stories and opinion essays of 150–200 words.

Your 30 minutes every day

Time	What to do
5 min	Review yesterday's words and sentences: cover the English and say it from the Arabic.
8 min	Learn today's 6 words and 2 sentences. Say each one aloud 5 times and copy it into your notebook.
10 min	Listen / watch today's resource from the weekly plan, using the 4-step method below.
5 min	Practise: do today's exercise in pencil, then check the Answer Key at the end of the book.
2 min	Speak: say 3 sentences about your day using today's words.

The 4-step listening method

#	Step
1	Listen only. Don't read. Try to catch the general idea.
2	Listen and read the script or subtitles. Underline new words.
3	Shadow: pause after each sentence and repeat it with the same sound and speed.
4	Listen again without the text. You will understand much more!

> Too fast? On YouTube tap ⚙ Settings → Playback speed → 0.75 and turn on English subtitles (CC) — not Arabic. After Weeks 4, 8 and 12 there is a Progress Check: score 16/20 or more to move on.

All Your Links in One Place

Every resource in this book is free. Tap a title in the weekly plan to find it, or use these main links:

Main listening course

- **BBC Learning English — 6 Minute English (podcast)**

- TED-Ed animated lessons (video)

British Council LearnEnglish (B1–B2)

- B1 listening (audio)
- B2 listening (audio)
- B1 reading (reading)
- B2 reading (reading)
- B2 writing (writing)

Grammar practice

- British Council — B1–B2 grammar (grammar)
- BBC Learning English — 6 Minute Grammar (podcast)
- BBC Learning English Grammar (podcast)
- engVid — Adam (video)
- engVid — Alex (video)
- engVid — Benjamin (video)
- engVid — James (video)

> If a link ever stops working, search the exact title in YouTube or Google — every lesson in this book has its exact name.

WEEK 1 OF 12

Decisions and Regrets

Grammar: Third conditional — If I had..., I would have...

This week's plan

Day	Learn	Listen / Watch	Practise
Day 1	Words: Making decisions · Sentences 1–2	**BBC 6 Minute English: "Is rejection good for us?" (podcast)**	Exercise 1
Day 2	Words: Regrets · Sentences 3–4	**British Council: "Making a decision" (listening)**	Exercise 2
Day 3	Words: Choices and risks · Sentences 5–6	**VOA Learning English: "Past Unreal Conditionals" (audio)**	Exercise 3
Day 4	Words: Consequences · Sentences 7–8	**TED-Ed: "The psychology behind irrational decisions" (video)** + **British Council: "Conditionals: third and mixed" (grammar)**	Exercise 4
Day 5	Words: Feelings after a decision · Sentences 9–10	**TED-Ed: "How to make smart decisions more easily" (video)**	Write & Speak
Day 6	Review all 30 words + 10 sentences	**BBC 6 Minute English: "Optimists vs Pessimists" (podcast)**	Redo mistakes
Day 7	Free day ☺	**BBC 6 Minute English: "Are you following your dreams?" (podcast)**	Tick your tracker

30 words to learn

Set 1 · Making decisions

make a decision	يتخذ قرارًا
weigh up the options	يوازن بين الخيارات
on the spur of the moment	فجأة / من غير تفكير
hesitate	يتردد
a turning point	نقطة تحوّل
think it over	يفكر في الأمر مليًا

Set 2 · Regrets

regret	يندم / ندم
miss a chance	تفوته فرصة / يضيّع فرصة
a missed opportunity	فرصة ضائعة
look back on	يتذكر / ينظر إلى الماضي
in hindsight	بالنظر إلى ما حدث / بعد فوات الأوان
with no regrets	دون ندم

Set 3 · Choices and risks

a leap of faith	مجازفة مبنية على الثقة / قفزة في المجهول
play it safe	يلعب على المضمون
a tough choice	اختيار صعب
torn between	حائر بين (خيارين)
a gut feeling	إحساس داخلي
go for it	يُقدِم على الأمر / يعملها

Set 4 · Consequences

as a result	نتيجةً لذلك
end up	ينتهي به الأمر إلى
lead to	يؤدي إلى
affect	يؤثر في
a consequence	عاقبة / نتيجة
backfire	يأتي بنتيجة عكسية

Set 5 · Feelings after a decision

relieved	مرتاح / مطمئن
disappointed	خائب الأمل / محبَط
thrilled	سعيد جدًا / فرحان جدًا
ashamed of	يشعر بالخجل من / مكسوف من
at peace with	متصالح مع
devastated	منهار / محطَّم نفسيًا

My extra words

10 sentences to memorise

1	If I had studied harder, I would have passed the exam.	لو كنت ذاكرت بجدٍّ أكبر، لكنت نجحت في الامتحان.
2	If we had left earlier, we wouldn't have missed the train.	لو كنا غادرنا مبكرًا، لما فاتنا القطار.
3	I took a risk and moved to Cairo, and it was a turning point in my life.	خاطرت وانتقلت إلى القاهرة، وكانت تلك نقطة تحوّل في حياتي.
4	In hindsight, it was the right decision.	بالنظر إلى ما حدث، كان ذلك هو القرار الصحيح.
5	Would you have accepted the job if they had offered you more money?	هل كنت ستقبل الوظيفة لو عرضوا عليك راتبًا أكبر؟
6	If Omar hadn't helped me, I would have been in serious trouble.	لو لم يساعدني عمر، لكنت وقعت في مشكلة كبيرة.
7	I need some time to think it over before I decide.	أحتاج إلى بعض الوقت لأفكر في الأمر قبل أن أقرر.
8	She hesitated for too long and missed a great chance.	ترددت طويلًا ففاتتها فرصة رائعة.
9	We weighed up the pros and cons and decided to stay.	وازنّا بين المزايا والعيوب وقررنا البقاء.
10	I have no regrets — I'd make the same decision again.	لست نادمًا؛ كنت سأتخذ القرار نفسه مرة أخرى.

Grammar of the week

Third conditional = an imagined past (it did NOT happen): If + past perfect, would have + past participle.

If I had known, I would have come. (= I didn't know, so I didn't come.)

If-clause (past perfect)	Result (would / could / might have + p.p.)	What really happened
If I had seen you,	I would have said hello.	I didn't see you.
If she hadn't missed the bus,	she wouldn't have been late.	She missed the bus and was late.
If they had asked me,	I could have helped them.	They didn't ask me.
If it had rained,	we might have stayed at home.	It didn't rain.

نستخدمه للكلام عن ماضٍ لم يحدث ونتيجته المتخيَّلة، ولذلك نستخدمه كثيرًا للتعبير عن الندم أو اللوم. الخطأ الشائع عند المتعلمين العرب هو ترجمة «لو كنت أعرف» حرفيًا فيقولون If I would have known، أو يستخدمون If I knew لأمر انتهى في الماضي. الصحيح: If I had known... ولا نضع would أبدًا بعد if. وانتبه: 'd قد تعني had (بعد if) أو would (في جملة النتيجة): If I'd known, I'd have come.

Question: What would you have done if you had lost your job?

would have = sure result · could have = possible result · might have = maybe.

Short forms: If I'd (= had) known, I'd (= would) have come. Never: If I would have known...

Exercises

Exercise 1 · Complete with the correct form of the verbs (third conditional).

1) If you ___ (tell) me, I ___ (help) you.
2) If we ___ (not take) a taxi, we ___ (miss) the flight.
3) Nour ___ (not get) the job if she ___ (not prepare) well.
4) If I ___ (know) about the traffic, I ___ (leave) earlier.
5) What ___ you ___ (do) if the bank ___ (refuse) your loan?
6) If he ___ (be) more careful, he ___ (not lose) his phone.

Exercise 2 · Correct the mistake.

1) If I would have known, I would have come.
2) If she had studied, she would pass the exam last year.
3) If we hadn't been late, we would have catch the train.
4) If you had asked me, I will have helped you.
5) If he has saved money, he would have bought a car.
6) I would have called you if I had have your number.

Exercise 3 · Rewrite using the third conditional.

1) I didn't set an alarm, so I overslept.
2) It rained, so the match was cancelled.
3) Mona hesitated, so she missed the chance.
4) We didn't book early, so the tickets were expensive.
5) They took a risk, so they made a lot of money.
6) Ahmed didn't revise, so he failed the test.

Exercise 4 · Translate into English.

1) لو كنت عرفت رقمك أمس، لكنت اتصلت بك.
2) لو لم نتأخر، لما فاتنا الفيلم.
3) ماذا كنت ستفعل لو خسرت وظيفتك؟
4) فكرت في الأمر مليًا واتخذت قرارًا.
5) بالنظر إلى ما حدث، كانت تلك فرصة ضائعة.

Write & Speak — “A decision that changed my life”: write 150–200 words about an important decision. Say what happened and how you felt, and use at least four third conditional sentences. Then tell the story aloud without reading.

Example: Five years ago, I made a decision that changed my life. I was working in a bank in Mansoura, and the job was safe but boring. One day, a friend told me about a job at a tourism company in Luxor. The salary was lower and my parents were worried, so I hesitated for weeks. In the end, I weighed up the pros and cons, followed my gut feeling and went for it. It was a turning point. In Luxor I used English every day, and I became much more confident. I also met my wife there! If I hadn't taken that risk, I would never have met her. If I had stayed at the bank, I might have earned more money, but I wouldn't have been happy. And if my friend hadn't called me that day, I would have missed the best opportunity of my life. Of course, the first months were difficult, and sometimes I felt frustrated. But looking back on it now, I have no regrets. I am proud of my decision, and I would make it again.

WEEK 2 OF 12

Life Lessons

Grammar: Mixed conditionals · unless / provided that / as long as

This week's plan

Day	Learn	Listen / Watch	Practise
Day 1	Words: Learning from experience · Sentences 1–2	**BBC 6 Minute English: "What can we learn from toddlers?" (podcast)**	Exercise 1
Day 2	Words: Values · Sentences 3–4	**TED: Robert Waldinger, "What makes a good life? Lessons from the longest study on happiness" (video)**	Exercise 2
Day 3	Words: Facing problems · Sentences 5–6	**BBC 6 Minute Grammar: "Conditionals review" (podcast)**	Exercise 3
Day 4	Words: Conditions · Sentences 7–8	**VOA Learning English: "Just in Case You Don't Use 'If'..." (audio)** + **BBC 6 Minute English: "The benefits of boredom" (podcast)**	Exercise 4
Day 5	Words: People who shape us · Sentences 9–10	**TED-Ed: "How to practice effectively...for just about anything" (video)**	Write & Speak
Day 6	Review all 30 words + 10 sentences	**British Council: "An informal email to a friend" (writing)**	Redo mistakes
Day 7	Free day ☺	**BBC 6 Minute English: "What's the key to happiness?" (podcast)**	Tick your tracker

30 words to learn

Set 1 · Learning from experience

learn the hard way	يتعلم بالطريقة الصعبة
a valuable lesson	درس قيّم
from experience	من التجربة / بالخبرة
wisdom	حكمة
mature	ناضج
grow up	يكبر / ينضج

Set 2 · Values

honesty	الصدق / الأمانة
patience	الصبر
respect	الاحترام / يحترم
keep your word	يفي بوعده
be true to yourself	يكون صادقًا مع نفسه
set an example	يكون قدوة / يضرب مثلًا

Set 3 · Facing problems

face	يواجه
overcome	يتغلب على
cope with	يتعامل مع / يتحمّل
give up	يستسلم
get through	يجتاز / يعدّي
bounce back	يتعافى بسرعة / يرجع أقوى

Set 4 · Conditions

unless	ما لم / إلا إذا
provided that	بشرط أن
as long as	طالما / بشرط أن
otherwise	وإلا
in case	تحسُّبًا لـ / احتياطًا
even if	حتى لو

Set 5 · People who shape us

a role model	قدوة
a mentor	مرشد / موجّه
inspire	يُلهِم
elders	كبار السن / الكبار
influence	يؤثر في / تأثير
look up to	يحترم ويقتدي بـ

My extra words

10 sentences to memorise

1	If I had listened to my father, I wouldn't be in this situation now.	لو كنت استمعت إلى أبي، لما كنت في هذا الموقف الآن.
2	If I were more patient, I wouldn't have shouted at him yesterday.	لو كنت أكثر صبرًا، لما صرخت في وجهه أمس.
3	I learnt the hard way that money isn't everything.	تعلمت بالطريقة الصعبة أن المال ليس كل شيء.
4	You won't succeed unless you keep trying.	لن تنجح ما لم تستمر في المحاولة.
5	You can borrow my car as long as you drive carefully.	يمكنك استعارة سيارتي طالما تقودها بحذر.
6	I'll help you, provided that you tell me the truth.	سأساعدك بشرط أن تخبرني بالحقيقة.
7	My grandmother was my role model; I always looked up to her.	كانت جدتي قدوتي؛ كنت دائمًا أحترمها وأقتدي بها.
8	Take an umbrella in case it rains.	خذ مظلة تحسُّبًا لنزول المطر.
9	Even if you fail, don't give up.	حتى لو فشلت، لا تستسلم.
10	Hard times teach us how to bounce back.	الأوقات الصعبة تعلّمنا كيف ننهض من جديد.

Grammar of the week

Mixed conditional 1 (past → present): If + past perfect, would + verb. If I had saved money, I would be rich now.

Mixed conditional 2 (present → past): If + past simple, would have + p.p. If I were braver, I would have said no.

unless = if ... not · provided that / as long as = only if.

Type	Form	Example
Past → present	If + had + p.p., would + verb	If I had taken that job, I would live in Dubai now.
Present → past	If + past simple, would have + p.p.	If I spoke English well, I would have got the job last month.
unless	= if ... not	Unless you hurry, you'll be late. (= If you don't hurry ...)
provided that / as long as	= only if	I'll come as long as I finish work early.

الشرط المختلط يربط زمنين: سبب في الماضي ونتيجة في الحاضر، أو صفة دائمة في الحاضر ونتيجة في الماضي. انظر إلى كلمات الزمن: now و today تعني would + الفعل، و yesterday و last year تعني would have + التصريف الثالث. أما unless فمعناها «إلا إذا / ما لم» وهي منفية بنفسها، فالخطأ الشائع أن نقول unless you don't come، والصحيح unless you come. وبعد unless و as long as و provided that نستخدم المضارع للمستقبل وليس will.

Wrong: Unless you don't study, you'll fail. ✔ Unless you study, you'll fail.

Wrong: as long as you will help me ✔ as long as you help me.

in case = to be ready for something that may happen: Take water in case you get thirsty. (It is not the same as if.)

Exercises

Exercise 1 · Choose the correct form.

1) If I had learnt to swim as a child, I (would be / would have been) more confident in the sea now.
2) If she weren't so shy, she (would speak / would have spoken) at the meeting yesterday.
3) If Omar were more organised, he (wouldn't forget / wouldn't have forgotten) his passport last week.
4) If we had bought that flat, we (would live / would have lived) in Alexandria now.
5) If he didn't love his job, he (would leave / would have left) years ago.
6) If I hadn't eaten so much, I (wouldn't feel / wouldn't have felt) sick now.

Exercise 2 · Complete with unless, as long as, provided that, in case or even if.

1) You'll miss the bus ___ you leave now.
2) I'll lend you the money ___ you pay me back next month.
3) Write down my number ___ you need help.
4) I'll go to the wedding ___ it rains — nothing will stop me.
5) ___ you apologise, she won't talk to you.
6) You can stay out late ___ you call me first.

Exercise 3 · Correct the mistake.

1) Unless you don't hurry, we'll be late.
2) I'll help you as long as you will be honest.
3) If I had saved money, I would had a car now.
4) If I didn't hate crowds, I would go to the concert with you yesterday.
5) Provided that you will finish early, you can leave.
6) If he studied medicine ten years ago, he would be a doctor now.

Exercise 4 · Translate into English.

1) لو كنت قبلت ذلك العرض، لكنت أعيش في لندن الآن.
2) لن تتحسن لغتك الإنجليزية ما لم تمارسها كل يوم.
3) يمكنك الخروج طالما ترجع قبل منتصف الليل.
4) تعلمت من التجربة أن الصبر مهم.
5) حتى لو كان الأمر صعبًا، لا تستسلم.

Write & Speak — “The best lesson life has taught me”: write 150–200 words. Describe what happened, what you learnt and give some advice. Use at least one mixed conditional and unless or as long as. Then record yourself telling the story.

Example: The best lesson life has taught me is that honesty always pays. When I was at university in Assiut, I worked part-time in a mobile phone shop. One evening, a customer paid me two hundred pounds too much. Nobody saw it, and I needed the money, but I ran after him and gave it back. He was so surprised that he thanked me again and again. A month later, the same man came back to the shop. He owned a big company, and he offered me a job because, as he said, he needed people he could trust. I still work there today. If I had kept that money, I wouldn't have this job now, and I would probably feel ashamed of myself. Life has taught me other lessons too, often the hard way, but this one was the easiest and the best. My advice is simple: be true to yourself and keep your word. People will trust you as long as you are honest with them, and unless you respect others, you can't expect them to respect you.

WEEK 3 OF 12

Social Media and the News

Grammar: wish / if only — present wishes and past regrets

This week's plan

Day	Learn	Listen / Watch	Practise
Day 1	Words: Online life · Sentences 1–2	**BBC 6 Minute English: "Is social media dead?" (podcast)**	Exercise 1
Day 2	Words: The news · Sentences 3–4	**TED-Ed: "How to choose your news" (video)**	Exercise 2
Day 3	Words: Fake or true? · Sentences 5–6	**British Council: "Wishes: 'wish' and 'if only'" (grammar)**	Exercise 3
Day 4	Words: Habits and problems · Sentences 7–8	**TED-Ed: "How false news can spread" (video)**	Exercise 4
Day 5	Words: Opinions online · Sentences 9–10	**BBC 6 Minute English: "Doomscrolling: Why do we do it?" (podcast)** + **VOA Learning English: "Three Phrases for Expressing Regret in English" (audio)**	Write & Speak
Day 6	Review all 30 words + 10 sentences	**British Council: "Social media influencers" (reading)** + **British Council: "A digital detox podcast" (listening)**	Redo mistakes
Day 7	Free day ☺	**BBC Learning English Grammar: "Regrets" (podcast)**	Tick your tracker

30 words to learn

Set 1 · Online life

tag	يُشير إلى شخص (في منشور) / يعمل تاج
share	يشارك / يعمل شير
a subscriber	مشترك (في قناة)
scroll	يتصفح بالتمرير / يقلّب
a livestream	بث مباشر / لايف
a notification	إشعار

Set 2 · The news

a correspondent	مراسل
a press conference	مؤتمر صحفي
a source	مصدر
breaking news	خبر عاجل
report	يذكر / يغطي (خبرًا) / تقرير
the media	وسائل الإعلام

Set 3 · Fake or true?

a hoax	خدعة / خبر ملفّق
a rumour	شائعة / إشاعة
fact-check	يتحقق من صحة المعلومة
credible	موثوق / ذو مصداقية
sensational	مثير ومبالغ فيه (لجذب الانتباه)
spread	ينتشر / ينشر

Set 4 · Habits and problems

addicted to	مدمن على
binge-watch	يشاهد حلقات كثيرة متتالية
waste time	يضيّع الوقت
a distraction	مصدر إلهاء / تشتيت
compare yourself to	يقارن نفسه بـ
a digital detox	فترة ابتعاد عن الأجهزة الإلكترونية

Set 5 · Opinions online

a comment	تعليق
a troll	شخص يتعمّد الإساءة والاستفزاز على الإنترنت
cyberbullying	التنمّر الإلكتروني
block	يحظر / يعمل بلوك
unfollow	يلغي المتابعة
a trend	موضة رائجة / تريند

My extra words

10 sentences to memorise

1	I wish I didn't spend so much time on my phone.	ليتني لا أقضي كل هذا الوقت على هاتفي.
2	I wish I hadn't shared that post without checking it.	ليتني لم أشارك ذلك المنشور دون أن أتحقق منه.
3	If only I had more free time!	ليت لديّ وقتَ فراغ أكثر!
4	The video went viral in just a few hours.	انتشر الفيديو انتشارًا واسعًا في ساعات قليلة فقط.
5	Always check the source before you believe a headline.	تحقق دائمًا من المصدر قبل أن تصدّق أي عنوان.
6	That story was a rumour; it wasn't reliable at all.	كانت تلك القصة شائعة؛ لم تكن موثوقة على الإطلاق.
7	My sister wishes she could switch off for a whole week.	تتمنى أختي لو تستطيع أن تبتعد عن كل شيء وترتاح أسبوعًا كاملًا.
8	I wish people wouldn't post rude comments.	ليت الناس يكفّون عن كتابة التعليقات الوقحة.
9	Stop comparing yourself to influencers — their lives aren't real.	توقف عن مقارنة نفسك بالمؤثرين؛ فحياتهم ليست حقيقية.
10	If only I had turned off my notifications before the exam!	ليتني أغلقت الإشعارات قبل الامتحان!

Grammar of the week

wish / if only + past simple = I want the present to be different. I wish I had a car. (I don't have one.)

wish / if only + past perfect = regret about the past. I wish I hadn't said that. (I said it.)

wish + could = ability · wish + someone + would = I want someone to change an annoying habit.

Meaning	Form	Example
Present wish	wish + past simple	I wish I lived near the sea.
Ability	wish + could	I wish I could speak French.
Past regret	wish + past perfect	I wish I had studied harder.
Annoying habit	wish + someone + would	I wish my neighbours would stop shouting.
Strong feeling	If only + the same forms	If only I hadn't lost my wallet!

بالعربية نقول «ليتني أعرف» بالمضارع، ولذلك يخطئ كثيرون فيقولون I wish I know. في الإنجليزية نرجع بالزمن خطوة إلى الوراء: للحاضر نستخدم الماضي البسيط (I wish I knew)، وللماضي نستخدم الماضي التام (I wish I had known). ومع فعل be يمكن استخدام were مع كل الضمائر: I wish I were taller. أما wish + would فتكون للشكوى من سلوك شخص آخر، ولا نقول I wish I would.

Wrong: I wish I know. ✔ I wish I knew.

Wrong: I wish I didn't go yesterday. ✔ I wish I hadn't gone yesterday.

For possible future things, use hope, not wish: I hope you pass the exam. (not I wish you pass)

Exercises

Exercise 1 · Complete with the correct form of the verb.

1) I wish I ___ (have) more followers.
2) I wish I ___ (not post) that photo last night.
3) If only I ___ (can) concentrate better!
4) Mona wishes she ___ (know) how to fact-check a story.
5) I wish my brother ___ (stop) playing games all night.
6) If only we ___ (check) the source before we shared it!

Exercise 2 · Write a sentence with I wish for each situation.

1) I don't have a laptop.
2) I believed a fake story and shared it.
3) I can't stop scrolling at night.
4) My friend always sends me silly videos at 2 a.m.
5) I didn't go to bed early yesterday.
6) I live very far from my work.

Exercise 3 · Correct the mistake.

1) I wish I know the answer.
2) I wish I didn't say that yesterday.
3) If only I have more time!
4) I wish I would be taller.
5) I wish you pass your exam tomorrow.
6) She wishes she can drive.

Exercise 4 · Translate into English.

1) ليتني لم أصدّق تلك الشائعة.
2) ليت لديّ متابعين أكثر.
3) تحقق من المصدر قبل أن تشارك الخبر.
4) ليتني أستطيع إغلاق هاتفي يومًا كاملًا.
5) انتشر الخبر بسرعة، لكنه كان كاذبًا.

Write & Speak — “Social media: friend or enemy?”: write an opinion paragraph of 150–200 words. Give your opinion, two reasons with examples, and one wish about your own habits. Then say your opinion aloud in two minutes.

Example: In my opinion, social media is a good friend but a dangerous enemy if we don't control it. On the one hand, it keeps us in touch with people we love. My cousin lives in Canada, and thanks to WhatsApp and Facebook, I see photos of her children every week. It is also a quick way to follow breaking news and learn new skills, such as cooking or English. On the other hand, social media spreads fake news and rumours very fast. Last year, a story about schools closing in Cairo went viral, and thousands of parents panicked before the ministry said it wasn't true. I wish more people would check reliable sources before they shared posts like that. Another problem is addiction. Many young people compare themselves to influencers and feel unhappy about their own lives. Personally, I wish I didn't spend three hours a day scrolling. If only I had started limiting my screen time earlier! Now I switch off my notifications after ten o'clock, and I already feel calmer.

WEEK 4 OF 12

Work-Life Balance

Grammar: Past modals — should have, could have, must have, might have, can't have

This week's plan

Day	Learn	Listen / Watch	Practise
Day 1	Words: Working life · Sentences 1–2	**BBC 6 Minute English: "Why are we all so stressed?" (podcast)**	Exercise 1
Day 2	Words: Stress · Sentences 3–4	**TED: Nigel Marsh, "How to make work-life balance work" (video)**	Exercise 2
Day 3	Words: Balance · Sentences 5–6	**engVid (James): "Could have, would have, should have – modals of lost opportunity" (video)**	Exercise 3
Day 4	Words: At the office · Sentences 7–8	**British Council: "Modals: deductions about the past" (grammar)** **+ BBC 6 Minute English: "Flexible working" (podcast)**	Exercise 4
Day 5	Words: Past modals · Sentences 9–10	**British Council: "Millennials in the workplace" (reading)**	Write & Speak
Day 6	Review all 30 words + 10 sentences	**TED: Shawn Achor, "The happy secret to better work" (video)**	Redo mistakes
Day 7	Free day ☺	**TED-Ed: "How to manage your time more effectively (according to machines)" (video)**	Tick your tracker

30 words to learn

Set 1 · Working life

a nine-to-five job	وظيفة بدوام ثابت (من ٩ إلى ٥)
a deadline	موعد نهائي / ديدلاين
a side hustle	شغل جانبي إضافي / شغلانة جنب الشغل
a commute	المشوار اليومي إلى العمل
job satisfaction	الرضا الوظيفي
remote work	العمل عن بُعد

Set 2 · Stress

under pressure	تحت ضغط
stressed out	متوتر جدًا / مضغوط
burnout	الاحتراق الوظيفي / الإرهاق التام
exhausted	منهك / مرهق جدًا
take a toll on	يؤثر سلبًا في / يرهق
on edge	متوتر / أعصابه مشدودة

Set 3 · Balance

quality time	وقت مفيد وممتع (مع الأسرة)
prioritise	يرتّب الأولويات / يعطي الأولوية لـ
set boundaries	يضع حدودًا
unwind	يسترخي / يفُكّ عن نفسه
recharge	يستعيد نشاطه / يشحن طاقته
a day off	يوم إجازة

Set 4 · At the office

a backlog	أعمال متراكمة / شغل متأخر
multitask	يؤدي عدة مهام في وقت واحد
a bonus	مكافأة / بونص
take on	يتولى / يتحمّل (مسؤولية جديدة)
delegate	يفوّض / يوزّع المهام
run late	يتأخر عن موعده

Set 5 · Past modals

must have done	لا بد أنه فعل
might have done	ربما فعل
can't have done	لا يمكن أن يكون قد فعل
should have done	كان ينبغي أن يفعل
could have done	كان بإمكانه أن يفعل
needn't have done	لم يكن ضروريًا أن يفعل (لكنه فعل)

My extra words

10 sentences to memorise

1	I should have left the office earlier; now I'm stuck in traffic.	كان ينبغي أن أغادر المكتب مبكرًا؛ أنا الآن عالق في الزحام.
2	You shouldn't have worked all weekend — you look exhausted.	ما كان ينبغي أن تعمل طوال عطلة نهاية الأسبوع؛ تبدو منهكًا.
3	Ahmed must have been really tired; he fell asleep at his desk.	لا بد أن أحمد كان متعبًا جدًا؛ فقد نام على مكتبه.
4	She can't have finished the report already — it's 200 pages!	لا يمكن أن تكون قد أنهت التقرير بالفعل؛ إنه ٢٠٠ صفحة!
5	They might have missed the email; let's call them.	ربما فاتهم البريد الإلكتروني؛ لنتصل بهم.
6	I could have asked for help, but I didn't want to look weak.	كان بإمكاني أن أطلب المساعدة، لكنني لم أرد أن أبدو ضعيفًا.
7	Long working hours started to take a toll on my health.	بدأت ساعات العمل الطويلة تؤثر سلبًا في صحتي.
8	I'm under a lot of pressure to meet this deadline.	أنا تحت ضغط كبير لتسليم هذا العمل في موعده.
9	It's important to set boundaries and switch off after work.	من المهم أن تضع حدودًا وأن تبتعد ذهنيًا عن العمل بعد انتهاء الدوام.
10	I spend quality time with my children every Friday.	أقضي وقتًا ممتعًا ومفيدًا مع أطفالي كل يوم جمعة.

Grammar of the week

modal + have + past participle talks about the past.

should have = it was a good idea, but you didn't do it (criticism / regret) · could have = it was possible, but it didn't happen · must have = I'm sure it happened · might / may have = maybe it happened · can't / couldn't have = I'm sure it didn't happen.

Modal	Meaning	Example
should have / shouldn't have	criticism or regret	I should have slept earlier. You shouldn't have shouted.
could have	possible, but it didn't happen	We could have taken a taxi, but we walked.
must have	I'm almost sure it happened	The roads are wet. It must have rained.
might have / may have	maybe it happened	He might have forgotten the meeting.
can't have / couldn't have	I'm sure it didn't happen	She can't have seen me — she didn't say hello.

في العربية نقول «كان لازم أعمل كذا» أو «لا بد أنه كان...»، فيترجم المتعلم حرفيًا ويقول I should went أو He must was tired. القاعدة ثابتة لا تتغير: modal + have + التصريف الثالث للفعل (should have gone, must have been). وانتبه: عكس must هو can't have (أنا متأكد أنه حدث) وليس mustn't have (أنا متأكد أنه لم يحدث). وفي الكلام السريع تُنطق should have مثل «شُدَف» (should've)، لكن لا تكتبها أبدًا should of.

Wrong: He must was tired. ✔ He must have been tired.

Wrong: She mustn't have seen me. ✔ She can't have seen me.

Never write should of / could of — it is should have (should've).

Exercises

Exercise 1 · Choose the correct modal.

1) The lights are off. They (must have / should have) gone to bed.
2) I'm so tired. I (shouldn't have / can't have) stayed up so late.
3) He (can't have / must have) written this report — he was on holiday all week.
4) I'm not sure where Nour is. She (might have / should have) gone to the bank.
5) We (could have / must have) won the match, but our goalkeeper made a mistake.
6) You (should have / might have) told me about the deadline! Now I'm late.

Exercise 2 · Complete with modal + have + past participle.

1) Omar looks very happy. He ___ (must / get) the promotion.
2) I ___ (should / not / eat) so much at lunch.
3) They ___ (can't / finish) already — they only started an hour ago.
4) She ___ (could / become) a doctor, but she chose art.
5) The manager isn't answering. He ___ (might / leave) early.
6) You ___ (should / ask) me for help.

Exercise 3 · Correct the mistake.

1) You should of called me.
2) He must was very busy yesterday.
3) She mustn't have heard the phone — she was in the garden.
4) I could have go to the party, but I was ill.
5) They might have forget the address.
6) We should have leaving earlier.

Exercise 4 · Translate into English.

1) كان ينبغي أن أطلب يوم إجازة.
2) لا بد أنها كانت منهكة بعد تلك الوردية.
3) لا يمكن أن يكون قد نسي الاجتماع.
4) ربما فاتهم القطار.
5) من المهم أن تقضي وقتًا ممتعًا مع أسرتك.

Write & Speak — Write an informal email (150–200 words) to a friend who has been working too hard. Say what you noticed, guess what happened (must have / might have), say what you should have done in a similar situation, and give advice. Then read it aloud as a voice message.

Example: Hi Karim, I hope you're OK. I saw you at Hany's wedding last Thursday, and you looked exhausted. You must have been working late again, and you might have missed lunch too, because you hardly ate anything. Your brother told me you've worked overtime every day this month. Please be careful. Two years ago I was in the same situation. I took on too many projects, I never said no to my manager, and I spent my weekends answering emails. In the end, I suffered from burnout and stayed at home for three weeks. I should have set boundaries much earlier, and I could have delegated some of the work to my team. I shouldn't have kept everything to myself. My advice is to talk to your manager about your workload and ask for flexible hours. Also, take a real day off soon and recharge. Switch off your work phone and spend some quality time with Salma and the kids. Shall we meet for coffee on Friday? Take care, Ahmed

PROGRESS CHECK

Progress Check 1 · Weeks 1–4

20 marks · no help · 20 minutes

A. Complete the sentences (10 marks)

1) If I ___ (know) about the party, I would have come.

2) If she had taken the job, she ___ (live) in Dubai now.

3) You won't pass ___ you study harder.

4) I wish I ___ (not say) that yesterday.

5) I wish I ___ (can) speak Chinese.

6) The streets are wet. It ___ (must / rain) last night.

7) You ___ (should / tell) me earlier!

8) She ___ (can't / see) me — she was in Aswan that day.

9) You can use my laptop as ___ as you're careful with it.

10) If we hadn't hesitated, we ___ (not miss) the chance.

B. Translate into English (5 marks)

1) لو كنت ذاكرت أكثر، لكنت نجحت.

2) ليتني لم أشارك ذلك الخبر الكاذب.

3) لا بد أنه كان متوترًا جدًا.

4) سأساعدك بشرط أن تقول الحقيقة.

5) كان بإمكاننا أن نأخذ تاكسي.

C. Write the Arabic meaning (5 marks)

1) in hindsight = _____

2) a rumour = _____

3) burnout = _____

4) overcome = _____

5) credible = _____

D. Speaking check — tick what you can do

☐ I can talk about a past decision and imagine a different result.

☐ I can give advice and set conditions with unless and as long as.

☐ I can talk about my online habits, my wishes and my regrets.

☐ I can guess what happened and criticise past actions politely.

My score: _____ / 20 18–20 Excellent · 16–17 Very good · under 16: repeat the sentences of these weeks for 3 days, then try again.

WEEK 5 OF 12

Customer Service and Complaints

Grammar: The passive in all tenses · have / get something done

This week's plan

Day	Learn	Listen / Watch	Practise
Day 1	Words: Making a complaint · Sentences 1–2	**BBC 6 Minute English: "Where do your tips go?" (podcast)**	Exercise 1
Day 2	Words: Customer service · Sentences 3–4	**British Council: "A phone call from a customer" (listening)**	Exercise 2
Day 3	Words: Shopping problems · Sentences 5–6	**BBC 6 Minute Grammar: "Active and passive voice" (podcast)** + **British Council: "Passives" (grammar)**	Exercise 3
Day 4	Words: Getting things done · Sentences 7–8	**BBC Learning English Grammar: "Using services" (podcast)**	Exercise 4
Day 5	Words: The result · Sentences 9–10	**British Council: "A letter of complaint" (writing)**	Write & Speak
Day 6	Review all 30 words + 10 sentences	**engVid (Benjamin): "English for Daily Life: Talking to Customer Service" (video)** + **BBC 6 Minute English: "Rude emails" (podcast)**	Redo mistakes
Day 7	Free day ☺	**BBC 6 Minute English: "How do you say sorry?" (podcast)**	Tick your tracker

30 words to learn

Set 1 · Making a complaint

complain about	يشتكي من
a complaint	شكوى
faulty	معيب / فيه عطل
damaged	تالف / متكسّر
reimburse	يعوّض / يرُدّ المبلغ المدفوع
a helpline	خط مساعدة / خط خدمة العملاء

Set 2 · Customer service

customer service	خدمة العملاء
be on hold	ينتظر على الخط
put someone through	يحوّل المكالمة إلى شخص
a reference number	رقم مرجعي
apologise for	يعتذر عن
sort out	يحل / يظبط (مشكلة)

Set 3 · Shopping problems

a warranty	ضمان
a voucher	قسيمة شراء / فاوتشر
deliver	يوصّل / يسلّم
a delivery	توصيل / شحنة (دليفري)
overcharge	يحاسب بأكثر من السعر
a courier	مندوب توصيل / مندوب شحن

Set 4 · Getting things done

have my hair cut	أقص شعري (عند الحلاق)
get my car serviced	أعمل صيانة لسيارتي (في الورشة)
have the flat painted	أدهن الشقة (عند نقّاش)
get my phone repaired	أصلّح هاتفي (عند فني)
have something installed	أركّب شيئًا (عن طريق فني)
get my suit dry-cleaned	أنظف بدلتي تنظيفًا جافًا / أوديها الدراي كلين

Set 5 · The result

compensation	تعويض
satisfied	راضٍ
unacceptable	غير مقبول
polite	مهذب / مؤدب
firm	حازم
escalate	يرفع الشكوى إلى مستوى أعلى / يصعّد

My extra words

10 sentences to memorise

1	I'd like to make a complaint about my order.	أود أن أقدّم شكوى بخصوص طلبي.
2	The washing machine was delivered yesterday, but it's faulty.	تم توصيل الغسالة أمس، لكنّ بها عطلًا.
3	My order still hasn't been sent, and I paid two weeks ago.	لم يُرسَل طلبي حتى الآن، وقد دفعت منذ أسبوعين.
4	Your complaint is being dealt with by our team.	يتم التعامل مع شكواك الآن من قِبَل فريقنا.
5	I was kept on hold for forty minutes!	جعلوني أنتظر على الخط أربعين دقيقة!
6	I'd like a refund or a replacement, please.	أريد استرداد المبلغ أو استبدال المنتج، من فضلك.
7	The problem will be sorted out within 48 hours.	ستُحَل المشكلة خلال ٤٨ ساعة.
8	I had my phone repaired, but it broke again a week later.	أصلحت هاتفي عند فني، لكنه تعطل مرة أخرى بعد أسبوع.
9	We're getting the kitchen painted next week.	سندهن المطبخ (عند نقّاش) الأسبوع القادم.
10	This is unacceptable. Can I speak to the manager, please?	هذا غير مقبول. هل يمكنني التحدث إلى المدير من فضلك؟

Grammar of the week

Passive = be (in the right tense) + past participle. We use it when the action is more important than the person who does it.

have / get + object + past participle = someone else does a job for you (you pay or ask them to do it).

Tense	Passive form	Example
Present simple	am / is / are + p.p.	Complaints are answered within a day.
Present continuous	am / is / are being + p.p.	Your order is being prepared.
Past simple	was / were + p.p.	The parcel was delivered yesterday.
Past continuous	was / were being + p.p.	The road was being repaired.
Present perfect	has / have been + p.p.	My money has been refunded.
Past perfect	had been + p.p.	The tickets had been sold before we arrived.
Future / modals	will be / can be / must be + p.p.	The problem will be sorted out. It must be fixed today.

have / get something done	Meaning
I had my car serviced.	A mechanic serviced it for me.
She's getting her hair cut tomorrow.	A hairdresser will cut it.
We've had the flat painted.	Painters painted it for us.

يخلط المتعلم العربي بين «قصّيت شعري» بمعنى ذهبت إلى الحلاق، وبين أن يقص شعره بنفسه: جملة I cut my hair تعني أنك قصصته بيدك! إذا قام شخص آخر بالعمل لك فقل I had my hair cut أو I got my hair cut. وفي المبني للمجهول يظهر الزمن في فعل be وحده، والفعل الرئيسي يبقى في التصريف الثالث دائمًا: is being repaired (يتم الآن)، has been sent (تم)، will be delivered (سيتم). والخطأ الشائع هو حذف be كقولهم The order sent yesterday، والصحيح The order was sent yesterday.

Use by + person only when it is important: The cake was made by my grandmother.

Wrong: I cut my hair at the barber's. ✔ I had (got) my hair cut at the barber's.

get something done is more informal than have something done.

Exercises

Exercise 1 · Rewrite in the passive.

1) They deliver the newspapers every morning.
2) Someone is repairing my laptop.
3) They sent the wrong size.
4) They have cancelled our flight.
5) They will refund the money next week.
6) They had sold all the tickets.

Exercise 2 · Complete with the correct passive form.

1) The lift ___ (repair) at the moment, so please use the stairs.
2) My complaint ___ (not answer) yet.
3) These phones ___ (make) in Korea.
4) The parcel ___ (deliver) tomorrow morning.
5) When we arrived, the food ___ (already / eat).
6) The faulty fridge must ___ (replace) immediately.

Exercise 3 · Rewrite with have / get something done.

1) A mechanic is checking my car. (I / have)
2) A technician repaired Mona's washing machine. (Mona / get)
3) The barber cuts my son's hair every month. (I / have)
4) A technician is going to install our new air conditioner tomorrow. (we / get)
5) A photographer took Nour's passport photos. (Nour / have)
6) The dry cleaner's has cleaned my suit. (I / have)

Exercise 4 · Translate into English.

1) أُلغيت رحلتنا ولم يعتذر أحد.
2) يتم إصلاح سيارتي الآن.
3) قصصت شعري أمس عند الحلاق.
4) لم يُرسَل طلبي حتى الآن.
5) أريد استرداد المبلغ، فهذا المنتج معيب.

Write & Speak — Write a formal email of complaint (150–200 words) to an online shop. Say what you ordered, what went wrong and what you want them to do. Use at least four passive forms. Then role-play the phone call to customer service with a friend: be polite but firm.

Example: Dear Sir or Madam, I am writing to complain about an order I placed on your website on 3rd March (reference number 58217). I ordered a microwave, and I was told that it would be delivered within three days. Unfortunately, the microwave was not delivered until 15th March, almost two weeks late. When the box was opened, I found that the door was damaged and the machine did not work at all. I called your customer service line three times, and each time I was kept on hold for more than thirty minutes. I was promised a call back, but nobody has contacted me since then. This is unacceptable, especially as the full amount has already been taken from my bank account. I would like the faulty microwave to be collected from my flat in Nasr City as soon as possible, and I would like a full refund. Alternatively, I would accept a replacement, provided that it is delivered this week. I look forward to hearing from you soon. Yours faithfully, Mona Adel

WEEK 6 OF 12

Science and Technology

Grammar: Future continuous and future perfect

This week's plan

Day	Learn	Listen / Watch	Practise
Day 1	Words: Technology today · Sentences 1–2	**British Council: "Innovation in business" (reading)**	Exercise 1
Day 2	Words: Science · Sentences 3–4	**British Council: "Why bridges collapse" (reading)**	Exercise 2
Day 3	Words: Innovation · Sentences 5–6	**British Council: "Future continuous and future perfect" (grammar)**	Exercise 3
Day 4	Words: Space and energy · Sentences 7–8	**TED-Ed: "How do self-driving cars "see"?" (video) + British Council: "The Martian: a book review" (reading)**	Exercise 4
Day 5	Words: Time in the future · Sentences 9–10	**British Council: "Asteroids" (reading)**	Write & Speak
Day 6	Review all 30 words + 10 sentences	**British Council: "A lecture about an experiment" (listening)**	Redo mistakes
Day 7	Free day ☺	**TED-Ed: "How do solar panels work?" (video)**	Tick your tracker

30 words to learn

Set 1 · Technology today

a gadget	جهاز صغير / أداة إلكترونية
an app	تطبيق / أبلكيشن
software	برمجيات / سوفتوير
user-friendly	سهل الاستخدام
wireless	لاسلكي
cutting-edge	حديث جدًا / من أحدث ما وصلت إليه التكنولوجيا

Set 2 · Science

research	بحث علمي / أبحاث
an experiment	تجربة علمية
a discovery	اكتشاف
a scientist	عالِم
prove	يُثبت
a hypothesis	فرضية

Set 3 · Innovation

invent	يخترع
an innovation	ابتكار
a prototype	نموذج أوّلي
launch	يطلق / يدشّن
a robot	روبوت / إنسان آلي
an electric vehicle	سيارة كهربائية

Set 4 · Space and energy

wind power	طاقة الرياح
renewable	متجدد
a planet	كوكب
a satellite	قمر صناعي
an astronaut	رائد فضاء
explore	يستكشف

Set 5 · Time in the future

by 2040	بحلول عام ٢٠٤٠
by then	بحلول ذلك الوقت
in ten years' time	بعد عشر سنوات من الآن
this time next year	في مثل هذا الوقت من العام القادم
within	خلال / في غضون
from now on	من الآن فصاعدًا

My extra words

10 sentences to memorise

1	This time next year, I'll be working for a tech company in the Smart Village.	في مثل هذا الوقت من العام القادم، سأكون أعمل في شركة تكنولوجيا في القرية الذكية.
2	By 2040, scientists will have found cures for many diseases.	بحلول عام ٢٠٤٠، سيكون العلماء قد وجدوا علاجات لكثير من الأمراض.
3	In ten years' time, most people will be driving electric cars.	بعد عشر سنوات من الآن، سيكون معظم الناس يقودون سيارات كهربائية.
4	Don't call me at eight — I'll be watching the launch online.	لا تتصل بي في الثامنة؛ سأكون أشاهد الإطلاق على الإنترنت.
5	By the time you get home, the update will have finished.	بحلول الوقت الذي تصل فيه إلى البيت، سيكون التحديث قد انتهى.
6	Will you be using your laptop this evening?	هل ستستخدم حاسوبك المحمول هذا المساء؟
7	The researchers have made an important breakthrough.	حقق الباحثون إنجازًا علميًا مهمًا.
8	There isn't enough evidence to prove it yet.	لا توجد أدلة كافية لإثبات ذلك حتى الآن.
9	Egypt is investing in solar energy in Aswan.	تستثمر مصر في الطاقة الشمسية في أسوان.
10	By the end of this level, I'll have learnt 360 new words.	بنهاية هذا المستوى، سأكون قد تعلمت ٣٦٠ كلمة جديدة.

Grammar of the week

Future continuous: will be + -ing = an action in progress at a time in the future. At nine tomorrow, I'll be flying to Aswan.

Future perfect: will have + past participle = an action finished before a time in the future. By Friday, I'll have finished the project.

Form	Use	Example
will be + -ing	in progress at a future moment	This time tomorrow, I'll be sitting my exam.
will be + -ing	polite question about someone's plans	Will you be coming to the meeting?
will have + p.p.	finished before a future time (by ...)	By 2030, they will have built the new city.
won't have + p.p.	not finished by then	I won't have finished by six.

العربية تستخدم «سـ / سوف» لكل المستقبل تقريبًا، أما الإنجليزية فتفرّق: «سأكون أعمل» (حدث مستمر في لحظة معينة في المستقبل) = will be working، و«سأكون قد أنهيت» (حدث سينتهي قبل لحظة معينة في المستقبل) = will have finished. الخطأ الشائع: By next year I will finish my degree، والأصح مع by أن نقول will have finished. وبعد by the time و when نستخدم المضارع البسيط وليس will: By the time you arrive (وليس will arrive).

Time words: future continuous → at this time tomorrow, this time next week, at 8 p.m. · future perfect → by, by the time, by the end of, before.

Wrong: By the time you will arrive ... ✔ By the time you arrive ...

Stative verbs (know, believe, own) don't usually take -ing: By June, I'll have known her for ten years.

Exercises

Exercise 1 · Future continuous or future perfect? Choose.

1) Don't phone at seven. We (will be having / will have had) dinner.
2) This time next week, Omar (will be lying / will have lain) on the beach in Hurghada.
3) By the end of the year, I (will be saving / will have saved) 20,000 pounds.
4) By 2035, scientists (will be sending / will have sent) people to Mars.
5) By the time the film starts, we (will be finishing / will have finished) our popcorn.
6) (Will you be using / Will you have used) the car tomorrow morning?

Exercise 2 · Complete with the future continuous or the future perfect.

1) By Monday, the technician ___ (install) the new software.
2) By the time you read this message, I ___ (leave) Cairo.
3) At ten tomorrow, I ___ (take) my driving test.
4) She ___ (not finish) the report by Thursday — it's too long.
5) In twenty years' time, robots ___ (do) most of the housework.
6) ___ you ___ (work) late tonight?

Exercise 3 · Correct the mistake.

1) By next June, I will finish my degree.
2) By the time she will arrive, we'll have eaten.
3) This time tomorrow I'll be fly to London.
4) By 2030, they will have build a new airport.
5) Call me later — at nine I will have watched the match.
6) In five years, I'll have living in Alexandria.

Exercise 4 · Translate into English.

1) في مثل هذا الوقت غدًا، سأكون مسافرًا إلى الأقصر.
2) بحلول عام ٢٠٣٠، سيكونون قد بنوا محطة طاقة شمسية جديدة.
3) هل ستستخدم الحاسوب الليلة؟
4) لن أكون قد أنهيت المشروع بحلول يوم الخميس.
5) حقق العلماء اكتشافًا مهمًا.

Write & Speak — “Life in 2040”: write 150–200 words about how science and technology will change your life and the world. Use the future continuous and the future perfect at least three times each. Then give a two-minute talk about your predictions.

Example: I think that by 2040 technology will have changed our lives completely. First of all, I believe that most people won't be driving their own cars. Driverless taxis will be taking us to work, and we will be using that time to read, rest or study. In Cairo, the traffic problem might finally be solved! Secondly, I am sure that scientists will have made huge breakthroughs in medicine. They will have found cures for some kinds of cancer, and doctors will be checking our health through small devices that we wear on our wrists. Energy will also be different. By 2040, Egypt will have built many more solar parks like the one in Benban near Aswan, and our homes will be using clean, renewable energy. As for me, I will be fifty years old. I hope I will be working from home three days a week and spending more time with my family. By then, I will have visited at least ten countries, and I will have learnt a third language — maybe Chinese!

WEEK 7 OF 12

Cities and Housing

Grammar: Reporting verbs — advise, suggest, promise, refuse, deny, admit

This week's plan

Day	Learn	Listen / Watch	Practise
Day 1	Words: City life · Sentences 1–2	**BBC 6 Minute English: "Will Covid-19 change cities?" (podcast)**	Exercise 1
Day 2	Words: Renting and buying · Sentences 3–4	**British Council: "Renting a house" (C1) (listening)**	Exercise 2
Day 3	Words: Describing a home · Sentences 5–6	**British Council: "Reported speech: reporting verbs" (grammar)** + **BBC Learning English Grammar: "Gossip" (podcast)**	Exercise 3
Day 4	Words: Reporting verbs 1 · Sentences 7–8	**British Council: "Getting advice" (listening)**	Exercise 4
Day 5	Words: Reporting verbs 2 · Sentences 9–10	**TED-Ed: "How the world's first metro system was built" (video)**	Write & Speak
Day 6	Review all 30 words + 10 sentences	**BBC 6 Minute English: "Do you need to declutter your home?" (podcast)**	Redo mistakes
Day 7	Free day ☺	**BBC 6 Minute English: "Could humans live in underwater cities?" (podcast)**	Tick your tracker

30 words to learn

Set 1 · City life

crowded	مزدحم
a high-rise	برج سكني / عمارة عالية
a traffic jam	زحمة مرور
public transport	المواصلات العامة
a neighbourhood	حيّ / منطقة
the suburbs	الضواحي

Set 2 · Renting and buying

rent	يستأجر / إيجار
a landlord	المالك / صاحب الشقة
a tenant	مستأجر
a deposit	تأمين / مقدَّم
a mortgage	قرض عقاري
move out	ينتقل من مسكنه / يسيب الشقة

Set 3 · Describing a home

spacious	واسع / فسيح
cramped	ضيق ومزدحم
furnished	مفروش
overlooking	يطل على
run-down	متهالك / قديم ومهمل
cosy	دافئ ومريح

Set 4 · Reporting verbs 1

recommend	يوصي بـ / ينصح بـ
urge	يحثّ
threaten	يهدّد
refuse	يرفض
agree	يوافق
encourage	يشجّع

Set 5 · Reporting verbs 2

deny	ينكر
accuse someone of	يتّهم شخصًا بـ
congratulate someone on	يهنّئ شخصًا بـ
insist on	يُصِرّ على
offer	يعرض (أن يفعل شيئًا)
blame someone for	يلوم شخصًا على

My extra words

10 sentences to memorise

1	The landlord promised to fix the air conditioner.	وعد المالك بإصلاح المكيّف.
2	My father advised me to rent a flat near my work.	نصحني أبي بأن أستأجر شقة قريبة من عملي.
3	The estate agent suggested looking at flats in New Cairo.	اقترح السمسار أن نشاهد شققًا في القاهرة الجديدة.
4	The tenant refused to pay the extra money.	رفض المستأجر دفع المبلغ الإضافي.
5	He denied breaking the window.	أنكر أنه كسر النافذة.
6	She admitted forgetting to pay the electricity bill.	اعترفت بأنها نسيت دفع فاتورة الكهرباء.
7	Our neighbour apologised for making so much noise.	اعتذر جارنا عن إحداث كل هذه الضوضاء.
8	Living in the suburbs is quieter, but the commute is longer.	العيش في الضواحي أهدأ، لكن المشوار إلى العمل أطول.
9	The flat was spacious and fully furnished.	كانت الشقة واسعة ومفروشة بالكامل.
10	They warned us not to sign the contract without reading it.	حذّرونا من توقيع العقد دون قراءته.

Grammar of the week

Reporting verbs show the speaker's purpose, not only their words. Each verb has its own pattern: verb + to-infinitive, verb + someone + to-infinitive, verb + -ing, verb + preposition + -ing, or verb + that.

Pattern	Verbs	Example
verb + to-infinitive	promise, refuse, agree, offer, threaten	She refused to pay. He offered to help.
verb + someone + to-infinitive	advise, warn, remind, tell, ask, persuade, urge, encourage	He advised me to wait. She reminded me to lock the door.
verb + -ing	deny, admit, suggest, recommend	He denied stealing it. She suggested taking a taxi.
verb + preposition + -ing	apologise for, insist on, blame someone for, accuse someone of, congratulate someone on	He apologised for being late. They accused him of lying. We congratulated her on passing.
verb + that + clause	admit, deny, suggest, promise, explain	He admitted that he was wrong. She suggested that we (should) leave.

بدلًا من تكرار said في الكلام المنقول، نستخدم أفعالًا تحمل المعنى: نصح، اقترح، رفض، أنكر، اعترف... والمشكلة أن لكل فعل تركيبًا ثابتًا يجب حفظه. أشهر أخطاء المتعلمين العرب: He suggested me to go (ترجمةً لـ«اقترح عليّ أن أذهب»)، والصحيح He suggested going أو He suggested that I (should) go. وكذلك He denied to take، والصحيح He denied taking. احفظ كل فعل مع تركيبه كأنه كلمة واحدة.

Wrong: She suggested me to go. ✔ She suggested going. / She suggested that I (should) go.

Negative: warn / advise someone not to do something: He warned us not to touch it.

“I'll help you,” he said. → He offered to help me. · “I didn't do it!” → He denied doing it.

Exercises

Exercise 1 · Choose the correct form.

1) The landlord agreed (to lower / lowering) the rent.
2) He denied (to take / taking) the money.
3) My friend suggested (to look / looking) for a flat in Maadi.
4) The doctor advised (me to move / me moving) out of the city.
5) She apologised (for being / to be) late.
6) They refused (to leave / leaving) the building.

Exercise 2 · Report the sentences using the verb in brackets.

1) "I'll pay the rent tomorrow," said the tenant. (promise)
2) "I didn't break the lift," said the boy. (deny)
3) "Why don't we live in the suburbs?" said Mona. (suggest)
4) "You should read the contract carefully," the lawyer told us. (advise)
5) "Yes, I forgot to lock the door," said Omar. (admit)
6) "Don't park here!" the guard told me. (warn)

Exercise 3 · Correct the mistake.

1) He suggested me to rent a bigger flat.
2) She denied to break the window.
3) They promised fixing the water heater.
4) I apologised to be so noisy.
5) My mother reminded me lock the door.
6) The landlord insisted to see the flat.

Exercise 4 · Translate into English.

1) نصحني صديقي بألّا أستأجر تلك الشقة.
2) أنكر المالك أنه أخذ التأمين.
3) اقترحت أختي أن ننتقل إلى الإسكندرية.
4) وعدني بأن يصلح الباب غدًا.
5) الشقة واسعة، لكن الحي مزدحم ومزعج.

Write & Speak — "The day we moved house": write a story of 150–200 words (real or imagined). Report what people said using at least six different reporting verbs. Then tell the story to a friend or record it.

Example: Last summer we finally decided to move out of our old flat in Shubra. It was cramped and noisy, and the building was run-down. My wife suggested looking for something in the suburbs, and after a month of searching we found a spacious flat in 6th of October City. Moving day was a disaster. The removal men had promised to arrive at eight, but they didn't come until eleven. When they finally came, the driver apologised for being late and blamed the traffic. Then one of the men dropped a box full of glasses. At first he denied breaking anything, but later he admitted that it was his fault and offered to pay for them. I refused to take his money; he looked so tired. Our new landlord met us at the door. He reminded us to read the electricity meter and warned us not to use the lift until it was repaired. By midnight we were exhausted, but my son insisted on unpacking his toys first. Now, a year later, we love our new neighbourhood.

WEEK 8 OF 12

Health and Medicine

Grammar: Articles — a / an, the and no article (advanced)

This week's plan

Day	Learn	Listen / Watch	Practise
Day 1	Words: Symptoms · Sentences 1–2	**TED-Ed: “What causes insomnia?” (video)**	Exercise 1
Day 2	Words: At the doctor's · Sentences 3–4	**TED-Ed: “How do germs spread (and why do they make us sick)?” (video)**	Exercise 2
Day 3	Words: Treatment · Sentences 5–6	**VOA Learning English: “What Is the 'Zero Article'?” (audio) + BBC 6 Minute Grammar: “The definite article with abstract uncountable nouns” (podcast)**	Exercise 3
Day 4	Words: Healthy habits · Sentences 7–8	**TED-Ed: “How does the immune system work?” (video)**	Exercise 4
Day 5	Words: People and places · Sentences 9–10	**BBC 6 Minute English: “Embarrassed to go to the doctor?” (podcast)**	Write & Speak
Day 6	Review all 30 words + 10 sentences	**TED-Ed: “How do vaccines work?” (video) + TED-Ed: “What is a calorie?” (video)**	Redo mistakes
Day 7	Free day ☺	**TED-Ed: “What would happen if you didn’t sleep?” (video)**	Tick your tracker

30 words to learn

Set 1 · Symptoms

a rash	طفح جلدي
a runny nose	سيلان الأنف / رشح
a temperature	حرارة / سخونية
dizzy	دائخ / دايخ
a cough	سعال / كحة
feel sick	يشعر بالغثيان

Set 2 · At the doctor's

make an appointment	يحجز موعدًا / يحجز كشف
examine	يفحص / يكشف على
a specialist	طبيب متخصص / أخصائي
refer someone to	يحوّل (مريضًا) إلى
an X-ray	صورة أشعة / أشعة سينية
a blood test	تحليل دم

Set 3 · Treatment

treatment	علاج
take medicine	يتناول الدواء
a painkiller	مسكّن
heal	يلتئم / يُشفى
an operation	عملية جراحية
antibiotics	مضادات حيوية

Set 4 · Healthy habits

a couch potato	شخص كسول قليل الحركة
get some fresh air	يخرج إلى الهواء الطلق / يشم هوا
have a sweet tooth	يحب الحلويات كثيرًا
give up smoking	يقلع عن التدخين
get enough sleep	ينام قدرًا كافيًا
stay hydrated	يشرب ماءً كافيًا

Set 5 · People and places

a pharmacist	صيدلي
a surgeon	جرّاح
a paramedic	مسعف
an emergency	حالة طارئة / طوارئ
a clinic	عيادة
a ward	عنبر / قسم في المستشفى

My extra words

10 sentences to memorise

1	I've had a sore throat and a temperature since Sunday.	عندي التهاب في الحلق وحرارة منذ يوم الأحد.
2	I'd like to make an appointment with a doctor, please.	أود أن أحجز موعدًا مع طبيب، من فضلك.
3	The doctor examined me and gave me a prescription.	فحصني الطبيب وأعطاني وصفة طبية.
4	My grandfather went into hospital for an operation.	دخل جدي المستشفى لإجراء عملية جراحية.
5	We visited him in the hospital near our house.	زرناه في المستشفى القريب من بيتنا.
6	Life is too short to worry about everything.	الحياة أقصر من أن نقلق بشأن كل شيء.
7	Doctors say that sugar is bad for the heart.	يقول الأطباء إن السكر ضارّ بالقلب.
8	This medicine may have some side effects, such as feeling dizzy.	قد يكون لهذا الدواء بعض الأعراض الجانبية، مثل الشعور بالدوار.
9	I'm trying to cut down on sugar and work out three times a week.	أحاول أن أقلّل من السكر وأن أتمرّن ثلاث مرات في الأسبوع.
10	It took her two weeks to recover from flu.	استغرقت أسبوعين حتى تعافت من الإنفلونزا.

Grammar of the week

a / an = one of many, first mention, jobs (She's a nurse).

the = something specific or already known, unique things (the sun), superlatives (the best).

No article = things in general with plural or uncountable nouns (Doctors work hard. Sugar is bad for you.) and in fixed phrases: go to hospital / school / bed / work.

Article	Use	Example
a / an	one of many, first mention, jobs	I saw a doctor. She's a surgeon.
the	specific / already known	The doctor I saw was very kind.
the	only one, superlatives	the sun, the best hospital in Cairo
no article	general plural / uncountable nouns	Vegetables are good for you. Stress causes illness.
no article	places used for their main purpose	go to hospital / school / university / bed

في العربية نقول «الصحة أهم شيء» و«الأطباء يعملون بجد» بأداة التعريف «ال» عند الكلام العام، فيترجمها المتعلم إلى The health is important و The doctors work hard، وهذا خطأ. في الإنجليزية الكلام العام يكون بلا أداة: Health is important. Doctors work hard. ونستخدم the فقط عندما نقصد شيئًا محددًا: The doctor who treated me was kind. وانتبه: go to hospital (للعلاج كمريض) لكن go to the hospital (لزيارة مريض أو لسبب آخر).

Wrong: The smoking is bad for the health. ✔ Smoking is bad for your health.

Illnesses: a cold, a headache, a temperature · but flu (or the flu), diabetes, cancer — no a.

Rivers, seas and musical instruments take the: the Nile, the Red Sea, play the oud.

Exercises

Exercise 1 · Complete with a, an, the or – (no article).

1) ___ exercise is good for your heart.
2) My sister is ___ nurse at ___ big hospital in Giza.
3) ___ nurse who helped me was very kind.
4) I have ___ terrible headache.
5) He broke his leg and was taken to ___ hospital.
6) ___ Nile is ___ longest river in Africa.
7) She works as ___ engineer.
8) ___ vegetables and ___ fruit are important in a balanced diet.

Exercise 2 · Correct the mistake.

1) The health is more important than money.
2) My uncle is surgeon.
3) I go to the bed at eleven.
4) She's best doctor in Alexandria.
5) The doctors say we should drink more water. (doctors in general)
6) I've got a flu.

Exercise 3 · Choose the correct option.

1) My mother is in (hospital / the hospital) — she had an operation yesterday.
2) I went to (hospital / the hospital) to visit my friend.
3) (Sugar / The sugar) on the table is for the guests.
4) (Sugar / The sugar) is bad for your teeth.
5) Can you pass me (a / the) salt, please?
6) He has (an / a) appointment at ten.

Exercise 4 · Translate into English.

1) الرياضة مفيدة للصحة.
2) الطبيب الذي فحصني كان لطيفًا جدًا.
3) أختي صيدلانية في الإسكندرية.
4) أحاول أن أقلّل من القهوة.
5) ذهبت إلى الطبيب لإجراء فحص دوري.

Write & Speak — “Is it easier to stay healthy today than fifty years ago?”: write an opinion essay of 150–200 words. Give your opinion, two reasons and examples. Check every a, an, the and no-article noun. Then discuss the question with a friend or family member.

Example: In my opinion, it is both easier and harder to stay healthy today than fifty years ago. On the one hand, medicine has improved enormously. When my grandmother was a child in a small village near Minya, there was no clinic, and people often died from illnesses that are easy to treat now. Today, vaccines protect children from many diseases, and most people can see a doctor or a pharmacist within minutes. On the other hand, our lifestyle has become much less healthy. My grandparents walked everywhere, worked in the fields and ate fresh vegetables, bread and beans. Nowadays, many of us sit at a desk all day, drive to work and eat fast food late at night. As a result, diabetes and heart disease are becoming more common, even among young people. Stress and lack of sleep are also serious problems in big cities like Cairo. To sum up, the knowledge is there, but the choice is ours. If we cut down on sugar, work out regularly and get enough sleep, we can be healthier than any generation before us.

PROGRESS CHECK

Progress Check 2 · Weeks 5–8

20 marks · no help · 20 minutes

A. Complete the sentences (10 marks)

1) My car ___ (repair) at the moment.
2) Our order ___ (not deliver) yet.
3) I had my hair ___ (cut) yesterday.
4) This time tomorrow, I ___ (fly) to Luxor.
5) By 2030, they ___ (build) a new airport.
6) He denied ___ (take) the money.
7) My doctor advised me ___ (cut) down on sugar.
8) She suggested ___ (rent) a flat in Maadi.
9) ___ health is more important than money. (a / the / –)
10) My brother is ___ engineer.

B. Translate into English (5 marks)

1) أُلغيت رحلتنا.
2) بحلول الوقت الذي تصل فيه، سأكون قد أنهيت العمل.
3) وعد المالك بإصلاح الباب.
4) أصلحت هاتفي عند فني.
5) لا تتصل بي في التاسعة؛ سأكون أشاهد المباراة.

C. Write the Arabic meaning (5 marks)

1) compensation = _____
2) cutting-edge = _____
3) a landlord = _____
4) a painkiller = _____
5) cramped = _____

D. Speaking check — tick what you can do

☐ I can make a complaint politely and firmly, in writing and on the phone.
☐ I can talk about future plans and predictions.
☐ I can report what other people said, promised, suggested or denied.
☐ I can talk about health problems, treatment and healthy habits.

My score: _____ / 20 18–20 Excellent · 16–17 Very good · under 16: repeat the sentences of these weeks for 3 days, then try again.

WEEK 9 OF 12

Education Systems

Grammar: Contrast and purpose — despite, in spite of, whereas, so that, in order to

This week's plan

Day	Learn	Listen / Watch	Practise
Day 1	Words: School and university · Sentences 1–2	**TED: Sal Khan, "Let's teach for mastery — not test scores" (video)**	Exercise 1
Day 2	Words: Exams and results · Sentences 3–4	**British Council: "A class forum" (writing)**	Exercise 2
Day 3	Words: Ways of learning · Sentences 5–6	**British Council: "Contrasting ideas: 'although', 'despite' and others" (grammar)**	Exercise 3
Day 4	Words: Contrast linkers · Sentences 7–8	**TED: Ramsey Musallam, "3 rules to spark learning" (video)** + **British Council: "Creating a study group" (listening)**	Exercise 4
Day 5	Words: Purpose linkers · Sentences 9–10	**TED-Ed: "The benefits of a bilingual brain" (video)**	Write & Speak
Day 6	Review all 30 words + 10 sentences	**British Council: "An opinion essay" (writing)**	Redo mistakes
Day 7	Free day ☺	**British Council: "An interview about listening skills" (listening)**	Tick your tracker

30 words to learn

Set 1 · School and university

compulsory	إجباري
a subject	مادة دراسية
a vocational school	مدرسة فنية / تعليم فني
a gap year	سنة فاصلة (بين المدرسة والجامعة)
a placement test	اختبار تحديد المستوى
enrol on	يلتحق بـ / يسجّل في (دورة)

Set 2 · Exams and results

a past paper	امتحان سابق (امتحانات السنين اللي فاتت)
revise for	يراجع / يذاكر للامتحان
a mock exam	امتحان تجريبي
grades	درجات
pass with flying colours	ينجح بتفوق
private lessons	دروس خصوصية

Set 3 · Ways of learning

problem-solving	حل المشكلات
spoon-feed	يلقّن / يقدّم المعلومة جاهزة
group work	العمل الجماعي
a webinar	ندوة عبر الإنترنت / ويبينار
self-study	التعلم الذاتي
a skill	مهارة

Set 4 · Contrast linkers

despite	رغم / على الرغم من
in spite of	على الرغم من
whereas	بينما / في حين أن
while	في حين أن / بينما
even though	مع أنّ / رغم أنّ
nevertheless	ومع ذلك

Set 5 · Purpose linkers

so that	لكي / حتى
in order to	من أجل أن / لكي
so as to	لكي
in order not to	لكي لا
so as not to	حتى لا
for + noun	من أجل + اسم

My extra words

10 sentences to memorise

1	Despite studying all night, he failed the exam.	رغم أنه ذاكر طوال الليل، رسب في الامتحان.
2	In spite of the high fees, many parents choose international schools.	على الرغم من المصروفات المرتفعة، يختار كثير من الآباء المدارس الدولية.
3	In Egypt, students often memorise answers, whereas in Finland they focus on projects.	في مصر كثيرًا ما يحفظ الطلاب الإجابات، بينما يركّزون في فنلندا على المشروعات.
4	I'm taking an online course in order to improve my skills.	ألتحق بدورة على الإنترنت لكي أطوّر مهاراتي.
5	She studies in the library so that nobody disturbs her.	تذاكر في المكتبة حتى لا يزعجها أحد.
6	I wrote everything down so as not to forget it.	كتبت كل شيء حتى لا أنساه.
7	He got a scholarship to study engineering in Germany.	حصل على منحة لدراسة الهندسة في ألمانيا.
8	Even though she had private lessons, she still found maths difficult.	رغم أنها أخذت دروسًا خصوصية، ظلّت تجد الرياضيات صعبة.
9	Critical thinking is more useful than memorising facts.	التفكير النقدي أكثر فائدة من حفظ المعلومات.
10	Nour passed her exams with flying colours.	نجحت نور في امتحاناتها بتفوق.

Grammar of the week

Contrast: despite / in spite of + noun or -ing · although / even though + subject + verb · whereas / while compare two different facts.

Purpose: to / in order to / so as to + verb · so that + subject + can / could / will / would.

Linker	Followed by	Example
despite / in spite of	noun or -ing	Despite the traffic, we arrived on time. In spite of being ill, she went to school.
despite the fact that	subject + verb	Despite the fact that it was expensive, he bought it.
although / even though	subject + verb	Although he studied hard, he failed.
whereas / while	subject + verb (two different facts)	My brother loves maths, whereas I love languages.
in order to / so as to	verb (base form)	I got up early in order to revise.
so that	subject + can / could / will / would	I left early so that I could catch the bus.

كلمة «رغم» في العربية يأتي بعدها اسم أو جملة، أما في الإنجليزية فلكل كلمة قاعدتها: بعد despite و in spite of يأتي اسم أو فعل بـ ing فقط (Despite the rain / Despite being tired)، ولا يأتي بعدهما فاعل وفعل مباشرة. فالخطأ الشائع Despite it was raining، والصحيح Although it was raining أو Despite the fact that it was raining. ولا نقول despite of أبدًا.
وللتعبير عن الهدف لا تقل for to learn أو for learn، بل قل to learn أو in order to learn، وبعد so that نضع جملة كاملة: so that I can learn.

Wrong: Despite of the rain ... ✔ Despite the rain ... / In spite of the rain ...

Wrong: I went to Cairo for study. ✔ I went to Cairo to study. (for + noun: I went to Cairo for an interview.)

Negative purpose: in order not to / so as not to + verb, or so that ... won't / wouldn't.

Exercises

Exercise 1 · Choose the correct linker.

1) (Despite / Although) the bad weather, the school trip went ahead.
2) (In spite of / Even though) she was tired, she kept revising.
3) Public schools are free, (whereas / despite) private schools are expensive.
4) He joined a course (so that / in order to) improve his English.
5) Speak slowly (so that / so as to) everyone can understand.
6) (In spite of / Although) having a scholarship, he worked part-time.

Exercise 2 · Join the sentences. Use the word in brackets.

1) It was raining. We played football. (despite)
2) She studied hard. She wanted to get a scholarship. (in order to)
3) I live in Giza. My brother lives in Alexandria. (whereas)
4) He saved money. He could pay the tuition fees. (so that)
5) Omar was ill. He sat the exam. (in spite of)
6) I set two alarms. I didn't want to oversleep. (so as not to)

Exercise 3 · Correct the mistake.

1) Despite of the noise, I finished my homework.
2) Although the high fees, they sent their son abroad.
3) I went to the library for study.
4) She took notes so that remember the lesson.
5) In spite of he was nervous, he gave a great presentation.
6) I whispered so as not wake the baby.

Exercise 4 · Translate into English.

1) على الرغم من المطر، ذهبنا إلى الجامعة.
2) أذاكر كل يوم لكي أنجح بتفوق.
3) أخي يحب العلوم، بينما أحب أنا اللغات.
4) غادرت مبكرًا حتى لا أتأخر.
5) رغم أنها أخذت دروسًا خصوصية، رسبت.

Write & Speak — “Are private lessons necessary?”: write an opinion essay of 150–200 words. Compare the two sides with whereas and despite / in spite of, and explain purposes with in order to and so that. Then give your opinion aloud in two minutes.

Example: Private lessons have become a normal part of education in Egypt. Many families spend a large part of their income on them, despite the fact that public schools are free. In my opinion, private lessons can be useful, but they are not always necessary. Supporters say that students need extra help in order to understand difficult subjects and get high grades in Thanaweya Amma. Teachers in private lessons explain slowly so that every student can ask questions, whereas classes at school often have fifty students. Some students also feel more confident in small groups. However, in spite of these advantages, private lessons have serious problems. They are expensive, and they take up students' evenings, so many teenagers have no time for sport, reading or rest. Even though they spend hours with tutors, a lot of students only memorise answers instead of developing critical thinking. To sum up, I believe private lessons should be the exception, not the rule. Schools should improve so that families don't need to pay twice for their children's education.

WEEK 10 OF 12

Culture and Entertainment

Grammar: Phrasal verbs — separable and inseparable

This week's plan

Day	Learn	Listen / Watch	Practise
Day 1	Words: Films and series · Sentences 1–2	**BBC 6 Minute English: "What makes a good story?" (podcast)**	Exercise 1
Day 2	Words: Arts and events · Sentences 3–4	**British Council: "Chatting about a series" (listening)**	Exercise 2
Day 3	Words: Separable phrasal verbs · Sentences 5–6	**BBC 6 Minute Grammar: "Phrasal verbs and prepositional verbs" (podcast)** + **British Council: "Phrasal verbs" (grammar)**	Exercise 3
Day 4	Words: Inseparable phrasal verbs · Sentences 7–8	**British Council: "Film reviews" (listening)**	Exercise 4
Day 5	Words: Giving your opinion · Sentences 9–10	**BBC 6 Minute Grammar: "4 types of phrasal verbs" (podcast)** + **TED-Ed: "How to recognize a dystopia" (video)**	Write & Speak
Day 6	Review all 30 words + 10 sentences	**British Council: "Star Wars and the hero myth" (reading)**	Redo mistakes
Day 7	Free day ☺	**BBC 6 Minute English: "The power of poetry" (podcast)**	Tick your tracker

30 words to learn

Set 1 · Films and series

the plot	الحبكة / أحداث القصة
the cast	طاقم التمثيل
an episode	حلقة
a series	مسلسل
a soundtrack	الموسيقى التصويرية
a spoiler	حرق للأحداث / سبويلر

Set 2 · Arts and events

a premiere	العرض الأول (لفيلم)
a box-office hit	فيلم ناجح جماهيريًا / مكسّر الدنيا
the audience	الجمهور
sold out	نفدت تذاكره / كومبليت
a venue	مكان الحفل أو الفعالية
a standing ovation	تصفيق حار وقوفًا

Set 3 · Separable phrasal verbs

put off	يؤجّل
turn down	يخفض الصوت / يرفض (عرضًا)
look up	يبحث عن معلومة (في قاموس أو على الإنترنت)
pick up	يلتقط / يتعلم بسرعة / يُقِلّ شخصًا
take up	يبدأ هواية جديدة
give away	يكشف (سرًّا أو نهاية قصة) / يتبرّع بـ

Set 4 · Inseparable phrasal verbs

look forward to	يتطلع إلى / مستنّي بفارغ الصبر
come across	يصادف / يلاقي بالصدفة
get into	يندمج في / يبدأ يحب (شيئًا)
take after	يشبه (أحد أفراد العائلة)
run out of	ينفد منه / يخلص منه
keep up with	يواكب / يلحق بـ

Set 5 · Giving your opinion

gripping	مشوّق جدًا / شادد
overrated	مبالَغ في تقديره / واخد أكبر من حجمه
a must-see	عمل لا بد من مشاهدته / لازم يتشاف
predictable	متوقَّع
moving	مؤثّر
hilarious	مضحك جدًا

My extra words

10 sentences to memorise

1	The concert has been put off because of the storm.	تم تأجيل الحفل بسبب العاصفة.
2	Can you turn the TV down? I'm on the phone.	هل يمكنك خفض صوت التلفاز؟ أنا أتحدث في الهاتف.
3	I didn't know the word, so I looked it up.	لم أكن أعرف الكلمة، فبحثت عنها في القاموس.
4	I'm really looking forward to the Cairo International Film Festival.	أتطلع حقًا إلى مهرجان القاهرة السينمائي الدولي.
5	I came across a brilliant Egyptian series last week.	صادفت مسلسلًا مصريًا رائعًا الأسبوع الماضي.
6	My son has taken up the oud.	بدأ ابني يتعلّم العزف على العود.
7	She takes after her father; they both love old films.	إنها تشبه أباها؛ فكلاهما يحب الأفلام القديمة.
8	The tickets sold out in two hours.	نفدت التذاكر في ساعتين.
9	Please don't give away the ending — no spoilers!	من فضلك لا تكشف النهاية؛ بلا حرق للأحداث!
10	The plot was gripping, but the ending was a bit predictable.	كانت الحبكة مشوقة جدًا، لكن النهاية كانت متوقعة بعض الشيء.

Grammar of the week

Separable phrasal verbs: a noun object can go in the middle or at the end: turn down the music / turn the music down. A pronoun (it, them, him, her) MUST go in the middle: turn it down.

Inseparable phrasal verbs never split: I came across an old photo. I came across it.

Type	Rule	Example
Separable + noun	object in the middle or at the end	Put off the meeting. / Put the meeting off.
Separable + pronoun	pronoun always in the middle	Put it off. (not Put off it)
Inseparable	object always after the particle	I came across an old photo. I came across it.
Three-part verbs	never separate	I'm looking forward to the film. We ran out of popcorn.

معنى الفعل المركب (phrasal verb) غالبًا لا يُفهم من كلماته منفصلة، فاحفظه كوحدة واحدة مع مثال. أشهر خطأ هو وضع الضمير في آخر الجملة مثل Turn down it أو I looked up it، والصحيح Turn it down و I looked it up. أما الأفعال غير القابلة للفصل فلا نضع شيئًا في وسطها: I'm looking forward to the trip. وانتبه: بعد look forward to يأتي فعل بـ ing لأن to هنا حرف جر: I'm looking forward to seeing you (وليس to see).

Separable: put off, turn down / up, look up, pick up, take up, give away, try on, fill in, throw away.

Inseparable: come across, look after, take after, get into, run out of, keep up with, look forward to, get over.

Wrong: I'm looking forward to see you. ✔ I'm looking forward to seeing you.

Exercises

Exercise 1 · Put the words in the correct order.

1) up / it / I / looked

2) the music / turn / please / down

3) them / I / off / put / can't

4) across / I / an old film / came

5) forward / looking / I'm / to / the concert

6) after / her mother / takes / Mona

Exercise 2 · Replace the words in brackets with a phrasal verb.

1) She (refused) the offer to act in the film.
2) We're (excited about) the summer holiday.
3) They (postponed) the festival until next year.
4) I (found by chance) a great bookshop in Alexandria.
5) I want to (start) photography as a hobby.
6) We have (used all our) tickets.

Exercise 3 · Correct the mistake.

1) Can you turn down it?
2) I'm looking forward to watch the match.
3) Please pick up them from the cinema.
4) She takes her grandmother after.
5) We ran out popcorn.
6) I came an interesting article across.

Exercise 4 · Translate into English.

1) أجّلوا الحفل إلى الأسبوع القادم.
2) لم أعرف الكلمة فبحثت عنها.
3) أتطلع إلى رؤيتك في المهرجان.
4) يشبه أحمد جدّه كثيرًا.
5) كان الفيلم مشوقًا جدًا، لكن النهاية كانت متوقعة.

Write & Speak — Write a review (150–200 words) of a book, film, series or concert you enjoyed. Describe it, give your opinion and recommend it. Use at least five phrasal verbs. Then record a one-minute spoken review, as if for your own channel.

Example: I recently came across an old copy of Naguib Mahfouz's Palace Walk (Bayn al-Qasrayn) in my father's bookcase, and I couldn't put it down. It is the first part of the famous Cairo Trilogy, and it tells the story of a family living in old Cairo in the years leading up to the 1919 revolution. The father, Al-Sayyid Ahmad Abd al-Jawad, is strict and serious at home but fun-loving with his friends outside. His wife, Amina, spends her life looking after the family and almost never leaves the house. Their children grow up in a changing country, and their dreams and problems are very moving. The plot is slow at the beginning, so some readers might give up after a few chapters. My advice is: don't! Once you get into the story, it becomes gripping. I had to look up a few historical events, but that made it even more interesting. In my opinion, the novel is not overrated at all. Mahfouz won the Nobel Prize in Literature in 1988, and after reading this book, I understand why. I'm already looking forward to reading the second part, Palace of Desire. A must-read!

WEEK 11 OF 12

Global Issues

Grammar: Advanced comparatives — the more ... the more, much / far / a bit + comparative, not nearly as ... as

This week's plan

Day	Learn	Listen / Watch	Practise
Day 1	Words: The environment · Sentences 1–2	**TED-Ed: "Is the weather actually becoming more extreme?" (video)**	Exercise 1
Day 2	Words: Society · Sentences 3–4	**British Council: "The Buy Nothing movement" (reading)**	Exercise 2
Day 3	Words: Taking action · Sentences 5–6	**VOA Learning English: "The More I Practice, the More I Remember" (audio)** + **British Council: "Modifying comparatives" (grammar)**	Exercise 3
Day 4	Words: Resources · Sentences 7–8	**TED-Ed: "What is the tragedy of the commons?" (video)**	Exercise 4
Day 5	Words: Comparing · Sentences 9–10	**BBC 6 Minute English: "Curbing our plastic addiction" (podcast)** + **BBC 6 Minute English: "Can we stop natural disasters?" (podcast)**	Write & Speak
Day 6	Review all 30 words + 10 sentences	**TED-Ed: "What are the universal human rights?" (video)** + **British Council: "A Plastic Ocean: a film review" (reading)**	Redo mistakes
Day 7	Free day ☺	**BBC 6 Minute English: "What makes you happy?" (podcast)**	Tick your tracker

30 words to learn

Set 1 · The environment

extreme weather	طقس متطرف / ظواهر جوية شديدة
a wildfire	حريق غابات
carbon emissions	انبعاثات الكربون
a natural disaster	كارثة طبيعية
melting glaciers	ذوبان الأنهار الجليدية
endangered species	أنواع مهدَّدة بالانقراض

Set 2 · Society

poverty	الفقر
homelessness	التشرّد
inequality	عدم المساواة
a refugee	لاجئ
human rights	حقوق الإنسان
population growth	النمو السكاني / الزيادة السكانية

Set 3 · Taking action

raise awareness	ينشر الوعي / يرفع الوعي
take action	يتخذ إجراءً / يتحرّك
a petition	عريضة / التماس جماعي
volunteer	يتطوّع / متطوِّع
donate	يتبرّع
reduce	يقلّل / يخفض

Set 4 · Resources

fresh water	المياه العذبة
a shortage	نقص / عجز
waste	نفايات / إهدار
biodegradable	قابل للتحلّل
a landfill	مكبّ نفايات
scarce	نادر / شحيح

Set 5 · Comparing

far more	أكثر بكثير
slightly	قليلًا / بدرجة بسيطة
not nearly as … as	أقل بكثير من / ليس قريبًا من
twice as … as	ضعف
the more … the more	كلما زاد … زاد
by far	بفارق كبير / بلا منازع

My extra words

10 sentences to memorise

1	The more we waste, the less we have for the future.	كلما أهدرنا أكثر، قلّ ما يتبقى لنا للمستقبل.
2	The sooner we take action, the better.	كلما تحركنا أسرع، كان ذلك أفضل.
3	Summers in Egypt are getting much hotter than before.	أصبح الصيف في مصر أشد حرارة بكثير مما كان عليه من قبل.
4	Recycling is far better than throwing everything away.	إعادة التدوير أفضل بكثير من رمي كل شيء.
5	Solar power is not nearly as expensive as it used to be.	الطاقة الشمسية أقل تكلفة بكثير مما كانت عليه في الماضي.
6	Egypt's population is more than twice as large as it was in 1980.	عدد سكان مصر الآن أكثر من ضعف ما كان عليه عام ١٩٨٠.
7	Water shortage is by far the biggest problem in our region.	نقص المياه هو أكبر مشكلة في منطقتنا بلا منازع.
8	We should cut down on single-use plastic.	ينبغي أن نقلّل من استخدام البلاستيك أحادي الاستخدام.
9	My cousin volunteers with a charity that helps refugees.	يتطوع ابن عمي في جمعية خيرية تساعد اللاجئين.
10	The situation is getting worse and worse.	الوضع يزداد سوءًا يومًا بعد يوم.

Grammar of the week

Big difference: much / far / a lot + comparative (much bigger, far more expensive). Small difference: a bit / slightly / a little + comparative (a bit cheaper).

the + comparative ..., the + comparative ... = one change causes another: The more you read, the more you learn.

not nearly as ... as = much less · (just) as ... as = the same · twice as ... as = double.

Structure	Meaning	Example
much / far / a lot + comparative	big difference	Cairo is much bigger than Luxor.
a bit / slightly / a little + comparative	small difference	This flat is a bit cheaper.
the + comparative, the + comparative	one change causes another	The hotter it gets, the more water we use.
comparative + and + comparative	continuous change	Prices are getting higher and higher.
not nearly as ... as	much less	Trains are not nearly as polluting as planes.
twice / three times as ... as	multiples	This car uses twice as much petrol as mine.

يقول المتعلم العربي very bigger ترجمةً لـ«أكبر جدًا»، لكن very لا تأتي قبل صيغة المقارنة؛ نستخدم much أو far أو a lot: much bigger. وفي تركيب «كلما... كلما...» نبدأ كل جزء بـ the ولا نترجم «كلما» حرفيًا: The more you practise, the better you speak (وليس Whenever you practise more, more you speak better). وانتبه لترتيب الكلمات: الاسم يأتي بعد more مباشرة: The more money you save, the more freedom you have.

Wrong: very more expensive ✔ much / far more expensive.

Short fixed forms: The sooner, the better. · The more, the merrier.

by far + superlative: Climate change is by far the biggest challenge.

Exercises

Exercise 1 · Choose the correct word.

1) Plastic bags are (very / much) more harmful than paper bags.
2) Today is (slightly / far) warmer than yesterday — only one degree.
3) Electric cars are (a lot / very) cleaner than old diesel cars.
4) The problem is (much / more) worse than we thought.
5) Life in the city is (far / very) more expensive than in the village.
6) Water is (by far / very) the most important resource.

Exercise 2 · Complete with the … the … .

1) The more you recycle, ___ (little) waste you produce.
2) ___ (early) we leave, the sooner we'll arrive.
3) The hotter the weather, ___ (much) water we need.
4) ___ (many) people volunteer, the more we can help.
5) The older he gets, ___ (wise) he becomes.
6) ___ (soon), ___ (good).

Exercise 3 · Rewrite so the meaning is the same. Use the words in brackets.

1) Trains are much less polluting than planes. (not nearly as)
2) My flat is 100 m². Your flat is 200 m². (twice as)
3) Prices keep going up. (higher and higher)
4) When you study more, you learn more. (The more)
5) Hurghada is a little hotter than Alexandria in summer. (slightly)
6) No problem is as serious as climate change. (by far)

Exercise 4 · Translate into English.

1) كلما قرأت أكثر، تعلمت أكثر.
2) الحياة في القاهرة أغلى بكثير من الحياة في القرية.
3) المشكلة تزداد سوءًا يومًا بعد يوم.
4) القطارات أقل تلويثًا للبيئة بكثير من الطائرات.
5) يجب أن ننشر الوعي بمشكلة نقص المياه.

Write & Speak — “What is the biggest problem facing the world today, and what can ordinary people do?”: write an opinion essay of 150–200 words. Use at least four advanced comparative structures. Then present your essay aloud as a short talk.

Example: In my view, climate change is by far the biggest problem facing the world today. Summers in Egypt are getting hotter and hotter, and heatwaves are much longer than they were when I was a child. Scientists warn that the higher temperatures rise, the more droughts, floods and food shortages we will see. Countries like ours, which depend on the Nile for fresh water, are especially at risk. Some people think that ordinary people can't do anything and that only governments can solve the problem. I don't agree. Of course, big companies produce far more carbon emissions than individuals, but our daily choices still matter. For example, taking public transport is not nearly as polluting as driving alone, and a fan uses much less electricity than an air conditioner. We can also cut down on single-use plastic, recycle and stop wasting food. Most importantly, we can raise awareness. The more people understand the problem, the more pressure they will put on governments to take action. And the sooner we all start, the better.

WEEK 12 OF 12

Personal Goals

Grammar: Gerund or infinitive? remember, forget, stop, try, regret — change of meaning

This week's plan

Day	Learn	Listen / Watch	Practise
Day 1	Words: Setting goals · Sentences 1–2	**BBC 6 Minute English: "Why do we procrastinate?" (podcast)**	Exercise 1
Day 2	Words: Motivation · Sentences 3–4	**British Council: "New Year's resolutions" (writing)**	Exercise 2
Day 3	Words: Obstacles · Sentences 5–6	**VOA Learning English: "Verbs That Change with Gerunds and Infinitives" (audio)** + **British Council: "Verbs followed by '-ing' or infinitive to change meaning" (grammar)**	Exercise 3
Day 4	Words: Verbs that change meaning · Sentences 7–8	**British Council: "A talk about motivation" (listening)**	Exercise 4
Day 5	Words: Celebrating success · Sentences 9–10	**TED-Ed: "Why you procrastinate even when it feels bad" (video)**	Write & Speak
Day 6	Review all 30 words + 10 sentences	**TED-Ed: "What is imposter syndrome and how can you combat it?" (video)** + **BBC 6 Minute English: "Are you flourishing?" (podcast)**	Redo mistakes
Day 7	Free day ☺	**TED-Ed: "The science of stage fright (and how to overcome it)" (video)**	Tick your tracker

30 words to learn

Set 1 · Setting goals

set a goal	يضع هدفًا
aim for	يسعى إلى / يستهدف
aspire to	يطمح إلى
long-term	طويل المدى
realistic	واقعي
a to-do list	قائمة مهام

Set 2 · Motivation

motivated	متحمّس / عنده دافع
determined	مصمِّم / عازم
commitment	التزام
stick to	يلتزم بـ
keep going	يستمر / يكمّل
self-discipline	الانضباط الذاتي

Set 3 · Obstacles

procrastinate	يماطل / يؤجّل عمله
a stumbling block	عقبة / حجر عثرة
fear of failure	الخوف من الفشل
lack of time	ضيق الوقت
get distracted	يتشتت
give in	يستسلم / يرضخ

Set 4 · Verbs that change meaning

remember	يتذكر
forget	ينسى
stop	يتوقف
try	يحاول / يجرّب
go on	يستمر / ينتقل إلى الخطوة التالية
mean	يقصد / يعني

Set 5 · Celebrating success

reach	يصل إلى
pay off	يؤتي ثماره / يجيب نتيجة
reward yourself	يكافئ نفسه
track your progress	يتابع تقدمه
a sense of achievement	شعور بالإنجاز
a dream come true	حلم تحقّق

My extra words

10 sentences to memorise

1	I remember feeling nervous on my first day at work.	أتذكر أنني شعرت بالتوتر في أول يوم لي في العمل.
2	Please remember to send me the report before Thursday.	من فضلك تذكّر أن ترسل لي التقرير قبل يوم الخميس.
3	I stopped eating sugar two months ago.	توقفت عن تناول السكر منذ شهرين.
4	On the way to Alexandria, we stopped to have lunch.	في الطريق إلى الإسكندرية، توقفنا لنتناول الغداء.
5	Try going to bed earlier — it might help you concentrate.	جرّب أن تنام مبكرًا؛ فقد يساعدك ذلك على التركيز.
6	I tried to call you, but your phone was off.	حاولت أن أتصل بك، لكن هاتفك كان مغلقًا.
7	I regret not learning English when I was younger.	أندم لأنني لم أتعلم الإنجليزية عندما كنت أصغر سنًّا.
8	We regret to inform you that the course has been cancelled.	يؤسفنا أن نبلغك بأن الدورة قد أُلغيت.
9	I'll never forget meeting my favourite writer.	لن أنسى أبدًا لقائي بكاتبي المفضل.
10	Set realistic goals and stick to them.	ضع أهدافًا واقعية والتزم بها.

Grammar of the week

Some verbs change their meaning: verb + -ing usually looks back (the action happened before); verb + to-infinitive usually looks forward (the action comes after).

remember / forget + -ing = a memory · remember / forget + to = a duty · stop + -ing = finish an activity · stop + to = stop in order to do something · try + -ing = an experiment · try + to = make an effort · regret + -ing = sorry about the past · regret + to = formal bad news.

Verb	+ -ing	+ to-infinitive
remember	I remember visiting Luxor as a child. (a memory)	Remember to buy bread. (don't forget to do it)
forget	I'll never forget seeing the pyramids. (a memory)	I forgot to call my mother. (I didn't call her)
stop	He stopped smoking. (he doesn't smoke now)	He stopped to smoke. (he stopped walking in order to smoke)
try	Try drinking warm water. (an experiment)	I tried to open the door, but it was locked. (an effort)
regret	I regret leaving school early. (I'm sorry I did it)	We regret to tell you … (formal bad news)
go on	She went on talking for an hour. (continued)	After her degree, she went on to do a master's. (next step)
mean	Being a doctor means working long hours. (involves)	I meant to call you, but I forgot. (intended)

في العربية «تذكرت أن أغلق الباب» و«أتذكر أنني أغلقت الباب» جملتان مختلفتان، وكذلك في الإنجليزية، لكن الفرق يظهر في شكل الفعل: remember to lock (تذكرت واجبًا ففعلته) و remember locking (ذكرى لشيء حدث). أشهر خطأ: I stopped to smoke ويقصد المتكلم «أقلعت عن التدخين»، لكنها تعني «توقفت لكي أدخّن»! والصحيح I stopped smoking. القاعدة البسيطة: ing تنظر إلى الماضي، و to تنظر إلى المستقبل.

Wrong: I stopped to smoke last year. ✔ I stopped smoking last year.

Wrong: Don't forget locking the door. ✔ Don't forget to lock the door.

Negative forms: I regret not studying harder. · Try not to worry.

Exercises

Exercise 1 · Choose the correct form.

1) Did you remember (to lock / locking) the door?
2) I'll never forget (to see / seeing) the sunrise over Aswan.
3) On his way to work, he stopped at a kiosk (to buy / buying) a newspaper.
4) I've stopped (to drink / drinking) coffee in the evening.
5) If you can't sleep, try (to drink / drinking) a glass of warm milk — it might help.
6) I tried (to lift / lifting) the box, but it was too heavy.

Exercise 2 · Complete with the -ing form or the to-infinitive.

1) I regret ___ (not / accept) that job offer.
2) We regret ___ (inform) you that your flight is delayed.
3) Don't forget ___ (track) your progress every week.
4) I remember ___ (feel) proud when I got my first salary.
5) After a short break, the teacher went on ___ (explain) the same lesson.
6) Omar finished his degree and went on ___ (become) a successful engineer.

Exercise 3 · What does it mean? Choose a or b.

1) I stopped to eat. a) I didn't eat any more. b) I stopped what I was doing so that I could eat.
2) I remember posting the letter. a) I have a memory of posting it. b) I must post it later.
3) Try adding some salt. a) Do it and see if it tastes better. b) It's very difficult to add salt.
4) She forgot to call him. a) She called him but doesn't remember it. b) She didn't call him.
5) I regret telling him. a) I told him, and I'm sorry I did. b) I'm sorry, but I have bad news for him.
6) He went on to study law. a) He continued studying the same subject. b) Studying law was his next step.

Exercise 4 · Translate into English.

1) أقلعت عن التدخين منذ عامين.
2) تذكّر أن تضع أهدافًا واقعية.
3) أندم لأنني لم أذاكر بجدٍّ أكبر.
4) حاولت أن أستيقظ مبكرًا، لكنني كنت متعبًا جدًا.
5) لن أنسى أبدًا رؤية الأهرامات لأول مرة.

Write & Speak — “My goals for next year”: write 150–200 words about one or two important goals: why they matter, what obstacles you expect and how you will keep going. Use remember, stop, try and regret with -ing or to. Then record yourself and listen again in three months.

Example: Next year I have two important goals. The first is to reach B2 level in English and get 6.5 in the IELTS exam. My dream is to do a master's degree abroad, and I'll need English for that. I still remember feeling embarrassed in a job interview two years ago because I couldn't answer a simple question in English. I never want to feel like that again. The second goal is to get fit. I've already stopped drinking fizzy drinks, and I'm going to try walking to work three days a week instead of taking a microbus. I know there will be obstacles. I often procrastinate, and I get distracted by my phone in the evening. Last year I tried to study every night, but I gave in after two weeks because my plan wasn't realistic. This time I'll study for thirty minutes a day, track my progress in a notebook and reward myself after every milestone. I don't want to look back and regret wasting another year. If I stick to my plan, I'm sure I'll achieve my goals.

PROGRESS CHECK

Final Check · Weeks 9–12

20 marks · no help · 20 minutes

A. Complete the sentences (10 marks)

1) ___ the rain, we went to the beach.
2) I'm saving money ___ order to study abroad.
3) My sister loves maths, ___ I prefer languages.
4) The music is too loud. Can you turn it ___?
5) I'm looking forward ___ (see) you.
6) The more you practise, ___ better you become.
7) This phone is ___ more expensive than mine. (much / very)
8) Trains are not ___ as polluting as planes.
9) I stopped ___ (smoke) last year.
10) Don't forget ___ (send) me the photos.

B. Translate into English (5 marks)

1) على الرغم من أنه كان متعبًا، ذهب إلى العمل.
2) أجّلوا الاجتماع إلى يوم الأحد.
3) الحياة في المدينة أغلى بكثير من الحياة في القرية.
4) أندم لأنني لم أتعلم السباحة.
5) صادفت صورة قديمة لجدي.

C. Write the Arabic meaning (5 marks)

1) a mock exam = _____
2) gripping = _____
3) a wildfire = _____
4) self-discipline = _____
5) whereas = _____

D. Speaking check — tick what you can do

☐ I can compare education systems and give my opinion with reasons.
☐ I can talk about films, books and culture using phrasal verbs.
☐ I can discuss global problems and compare possible solutions.
☐ I can talk about my goals, my memories and my regrets.

My score: _____ / 20 18–20 Excellent · 16–17 Very good · under 16: repeat the sentences of these weeks for 3 days, then try again.

You Finished Level 4! What Next?

Congratulations — in 12 weeks you learned 360 new words and expressions, 120 key sentences and the most important intermediate grammar. You can now discuss real topics, write longer texts and follow authentic English. Keep your 30 minutes a day!

- Go back to the 120 sentences of this level once a week and say them aloud from memory.
- Listen to one BBC 6 Minute English episode every day — first without the transcript, then with it.
- Watch one TED-Ed lesson a week with English subtitles, and write a 5-line summary of it.
- Move to the British Council B2 listening and reading lessons, and try the C1 lessons when they feel easy.
- Write one 200-word text a week (email, review or opinion essay) and correct it with the rules from this level.
- When you are ready, start Level 5 to reach a confident B2.

أنت الآن في مرحلة التحول من «أفهم» إلى «أتكلم براحة». لا تخف من الأخطاء؛ تكلّم كل يوم ولو خمس دقائق، وسجّل صوتك وقارنه بالمتحدثين في الحلقات، وستلاحظ الفرق خلال أسابيع.

My progress tracker

Tick ✔ each day you finish your 30 minutes.

Week	D1	D2	D3	D4	D5	D6	D7	Notes
Week 1								
Week 2								
Week 3								
Week 4								
Week 5								
Week 6								
Week 7								
Week 8								
Week 9								
Week 10								
Week 11								
Week 12								

Answer Key

Check your answers after you finish each exercise. Translations can have other correct forms — if you are not sure, ask your teacher.

Week 1 · Decisions and Regrets

	Answers
Exercise 1	1) had told · would have helped · 2) hadn't taken · would have missed · 3) wouldn't have got · hadn't prepared · 4) had known · would have left · 5) would … have done · had refused · 6) had been · wouldn't have lost
Exercise 2	1) If I had known, I would have come. · 2) …she would have passed the exam last year. · 3) …we would have caught the train. · 4) …I would have helped you. · 5) If he had saved money, he would have bought a car. · 6) … if I had had your number.
Exercise 3	1) If I had set an alarm, I wouldn't have overslept. · 2) If it hadn't rained, the match wouldn't have been cancelled. · 3) If Mona hadn't hesitated, she wouldn't have missed the chance. · 4) If we had booked early, the tickets wouldn't have been (so) expensive. · 5) If they hadn't taken a risk, they wouldn't have made a lot of money. / If they had played it safe, they wouldn't have made a lot of money. · 6) If Ahmed had revised, he wouldn't have failed the test.
Exercise 4	1) If I had known your number yesterday, I would have called you. / If I'd known your number yesterday, I'd have called you. · 2) If we hadn't been late, we wouldn't have missed the film. · 3) What would you have done if you had lost your job? · 4) I thought it over and made a decision. / I thought about it carefully and made a decision. · 5) In hindsight, it was a missed opportunity. / Looking back, it was a missed opportunity.

Week 2 · Life Lessons

	Answers
Exercise 1	1) would be · 2) would have spoken · 3) wouldn't have forgotten · 4) would live · 5) would have left · 6) wouldn't feel
Exercise 2	1) unless · 2) as long as / provided that · 3) in case · 4) even if · 5) Unless · 6) as long as / provided that
Exercise 3	1) Unless you hurry, we'll be late. · 2) …as long as you are honest. · 3) …I would have a car now. · 4) …I would have gone to the concert with you yesterday. · 5) Provided that you finish early, you can leave. · 6) If he had studied medicine ten years ago, he would be a doctor now.
Exercise 4	1) If I had accepted that offer, I would live (would be living) in London now. / If I'd accepted that offer, I'd be living in London now. · 2) Your English won't improve unless you practise it every day. / Your English won't get better unless you practise (it) every day. · 3) You can go out as long as you come back before midnight. / You can go out provided that you come back before midnight. · 4) I learnt from experience that patience is important. · 5) Even if it's difficult, don't give up. / Even if it is hard, don't give up.

Week 3 · Social Media and the News

	Answers
Exercise 1	1) had · 2) hadn't posted · 3) could · 4) knew · 5) would stop · 6) had checked
Exercise 2	1) I wish I had a laptop. · 2) I wish I hadn't believed (shared) that fake story. / I wish I had checked the story before I shared it. · 3) I wish I could stop scrolling at night. · 4) I wish my friend wouldn't send me silly videos at 2 a.m. / I wish my friend would stop sending me silly videos at 2 a.m. · 5) I wish I had gone to bed early yesterday. / I wish I had gone to bed earlier yesterday. · 6) I wish I didn't live so far from my work. / I wish I lived near my work.
Exercise 3	1) I wish I knew the answer. · 2) I wish I hadn't said that yesterday. · 3) If only I had more time! · 4) I wish I were (was) taller. · 5) I hope you pass your exam tomorrow. · 6) She wishes she could drive.
Exercise 4	1) I wish I hadn't believed that rumour. / If only I hadn't believed that rumour. · 2) I wish I had more followers. · 3) Check the source before you share the news. / Check the source before sharing the news. · 4) I wish I could switch off my phone for a whole day. / I wish I could turn off my phone for a whole day. · 5) The news spread quickly, but it was fake. / The news spread fast, but it was false.

Week 4 · Work-Life Balance

	Answers
Exercise 1	1) must have · 2) shouldn't have · 3) can't have · 4) might have · 5) could have · 6) should have
Exercise 2	1) must have got · 2) shouldn't have eaten · 3) can't have finished / couldn't have finished · 4) could have become · 5) might have left / may have left · 6) should have asked
Exercise 3	1) You should have called me. · 2) He must have been very busy yesterday. · 3) She can't have heard the phone... / She couldn't have heard the phone... · 4) I could have gone to the party... · 5) They might have forgotten the address. · 6) We should have left earlier.
Exercise 4	1) I should have asked for a day off. / I should have taken a day off. · 2) She must have been exhausted after that shift. · 3) He can't have forgotten the meeting. / He couldn't have forgotten the meeting. · 4) They might have missed the train. / They may have missed the train. · 5) It's important to spend quality time with your family. / It's important to spend some good time with your family.

Progress Check 1 · Weeks 1–4

	Answers
A	1) had known · 2) would live (would be living) · 3) unless · 4) hadn't said · 5) could · 6) must have rained · 7) should have told · 8) can't have seen / couldn't have seen · 9) long · 10) wouldn't have missed
B	1) If I had studied more, I would have passed. / If I had studied harder, I would have passed. · 2) I wish I hadn't shared that fake news. · 3) He must have been very stressed (out). / He must have been very nervous. · 4) I'll help you provided that (as long as) you tell the truth. · 5) We could have taken a taxi. / We could have got a taxi.
C	1) بالنظر إلى ما حدث / بعد فوات الأوان · 2) شائعة / إشاعة · 3) الاحتراق الوظيفي / الإرهاق التام · 4) يتغلب على · 5) موثوق / ذو مصداقية

Week 5 · Customer Service and Complaints

	Answers
Exercise 1	1) The newspapers are delivered every morning. · 2) My laptop is being repaired. · 3) The wrong size was sent. · 4) Our flight has been cancelled. · 5) The money will be refunded next week. · 6) All the tickets had been sold.
Exercise 2	1) is being repaired · 2) hasn't been answered · 3) are made · 4) will be delivered · 5) had already been eaten · 6) be replaced
Exercise 3	1) I'm having my car checked. · 2) Mona got her washing machine repaired. · 3) I have my son's hair cut every month. · 4) We're going to get our new air conditioner installed tomorrow. · 5) Nour had her passport photos taken. · 6) I've had my suit cleaned. / I've had my suit dry-cleaned.
Exercise 4	1) Our flight was cancelled and nobody apologised. / Our flight was cancelled and no one apologised. · 2) My car is being repaired now. / My car is being fixed now. · 3) I had (got) my hair cut at the barber's yesterday. · 4) My order hasn't been sent yet. · 5) I'd like a refund; this product is faulty. / I want my money back; this product is faulty.

Week 6 · Science and Technology

	Answers
Exercise 1	1) will be having · 2) will be lying · 3) will have saved · 4) will have sent · 5) will have finished · 6) Will you be using
Exercise 2	1) will have installed · 2) will have left · 3) will be taking · 4) won't have finished · 5) will be doing · 6) Will ... be working
Exercise 3	1) By next June, I will have finished my degree. · 2) By the time she arrives, we'll have eaten. · 3) This time tomorrow I'll be flying to London. · 4) By 2030, they will have built a new airport. · 5) ...at nine I will be watching the match. · 6) In five years, I'll be living in Alexandria.
Exercise 4	1) This time tomorrow, I'll be travelling to Luxor. / This time tomorrow, I'll be flying (going) to Luxor. · 2) By 2030, they will have built a new solar power station. / By 2030, they will have built a new solar power plant. · 3) Will you be using the computer tonight? · 4) I won't have finished the project by Thursday. · 5) Scientists have made an important discovery. / Scientists made an important discovery.

Week 7 · Cities and Housing

	Answers
Exercise 1	1) to lower · 2) taking · 3) looking · 4) me to move · 5) for being · 6) to leave
Exercise 2	1) The tenant promised to pay the rent the next day. / The tenant promised (that) he would pay the rent the following day. · 2) The boy denied breaking the lift. / The boy denied that he had broken the lift. · 3) Mona suggested living in the suburbs. / Mona suggested that they (should) live in the suburbs. · 4) The lawyer advised us to read the contract carefully. · 5) Omar admitted forgetting (that he had forgotten) to lock the door. · 6) The guard warned me not to park there.
Exercise 3	1) He suggested renting a bigger flat. / He suggested that I (should) rent a bigger flat. · 2) She denied breaking the window. · 3) They promised to fix the water heater. · 4) I apologised for being so noisy. · 5) My mother reminded me to lock the door. · 6) The landlord insisted on seeing the flat.
Exercise 4	1) My friend advised me not to rent that flat. · 2) The landlord denied taking the deposit. / The landlord denied that he had taken the deposit. · 3) My sister suggested moving (that we move) to Alexandria. · 4) He promised to fix the door tomorrow. / He promised to fix the door the next day. · 5) The flat is spacious, but the neighbourhood is crowded and noisy.

Week 8 · Health and Medicine

	Answers
Exercise 1	1) – · 2) a · a · 3) The · 4) a · 5) – (British English: taken to hospital as a patient; the hospital is also accepted) · 6) The · the · 7) an · 8) – · –
Exercise 2	1) Health is more important than money. · 2) My uncle is a surgeon. · 3) I go to bed at eleven. · 4) She's the best doctor in Alexandria. · 5) Doctors say we should drink more water. · 6) I've got flu. / I've got the flu.
Exercise 3	1) hospital · 2) the hospital · 3) The sugar · 4) Sugar · 5) the · 6) an
Exercise 4	1) Exercise is good for your health. / Sport is good for your health. / Exercise is good for health. · 2) The doctor who examined me was very kind. / The doctor who examined me was really nice. · 3) My sister is a pharmacist in Alexandria. · 4) I'm trying to cut down on coffee. · 5) I went to the doctor's for a check-up. / I went to the doctor for a check-up.

Progress Check 2 · Weeks 5–8

	Answers
A	1) is being repaired · 2) hasn't been delivered · 3) cut · 4) will be flying · 5) will have built · 6) taking · 7) to cut · 8) renting · 9) – (no article) · 10) an
B	1) Our flight was (has been) cancelled. · 2) By the time you arrive, I'll have finished (the) work. / By the time you get here, I will have finished the work. · 3) The landlord promised to fix the door. · 4) I had (got) my phone repaired. / I had my phone fixed. · 5) Don't call me at nine — I'll be watching the match.
C	1) ضيق ومزدحم · 2) تعويض حديث جدًا / من أحدث ما وصلت إليه التكنولوجيا · 3) المالك / صاحب الشقة · 4) مسكّن · 5)

Week 9 · Education Systems

	Answers
Exercise 1	1) Despite · 2) Even though · 3) whereas · 4) in order to · 5) so that · 6) In spite of
Exercise 2	1) Despite the rain, we played football. / Despite the fact that it was raining, we played football. · 2) She studied hard in order to get a scholarship. · 3) I live in Giza, whereas my brother lives in Alexandria. · 4) He saved money so that he could pay the tuition fees. · 5) In spite of being ill, Omar sat the exam. / In spite of the fact that he was ill, Omar sat the exam. · 6) I set two alarms so as not to oversleep.
Exercise 3	1) Despite the noise, I finished my homework. · 2) Despite (In spite of) the high fees, they sent their son abroad. · 3) I went to the library to study. · 4) She took notes so that she could remember the lesson. / ...in order to remember the lesson. · 5) In spite of being nervous, ... / Although he was nervous, ... · 6) I whispered so as not to wake the baby.
Exercise 4	1) Despite the rain, we went to university. / In spite of the rain, we went to (the) university. · 2) I study every day in order to pass with flying colours. / I study every day so that I can pass with flying colours. · 3) My brother

	Answers
	loves science, whereas I love languages. / My brother loves science, while I love languages. · 4) I left early so as not to be late. / I left early in order not to be late. / I left early so that I wouldn't be late. · 5) Even though (Although) she had private lessons, she failed.

Week 10 · Culture and Entertainment

	Answers
Exercise 1	1) I looked it up. · 2) Please turn the music down. / Please turn down the music. · 3) I can't put them off. · 4) I came across an old film. · 5) I'm looking forward to the concert. · 6) Mona takes after her mother.
Exercise 2	1) turned down · 2) looking forward to · 3) put off · 4) came across · 5) take up · 6) run out of
Exercise 3	1) Can you turn it down? · 2) I'm looking forward to watching the match. · 3) Please pick them up from the cinema. · 4) She takes after her grandmother. · 5) We ran out of popcorn. · 6) I came across an interesting article.
Exercise 4	1) They put the concert off (put off the concert) until next week. / They put off the concert till next week. · 2) I didn't know the word, so I looked it up. · 3) I'm looking forward to seeing you at the festival. · 4) Ahmed really takes after his grandfather. · 5) The film was gripping, but the ending was predictable. / The film was really exciting, but the ending was predictable.

Week 11 · Global Issues

	Answers
Exercise 1	1) much · 2) slightly · 3) a lot · 4) much · 5) far · 6) by far
Exercise 2	1) the less · 2) The earlier · 3) the more · 4) The more · 5) the wiser · 6) The sooner · the better
Exercise 3	1) Trains are not nearly as polluting as planes. / Trains aren't nearly as polluting as planes. · 2) Your flat is twice as big as mine. / Your flat is twice as large as mine. · 3) Prices are getting higher and higher. · 4) The more you study, the more you learn. · 5) Hurghada is slightly hotter than Alexandria in summer. · 6) Climate change is by far the most serious problem. / Climate change is by far the most serious problem of all.
Exercise 4	1) The more you read, the more you learn. / The more I read, the more I learn. · 2) Life in Cairo is much (far) more expensive than life in the village. · 3) The problem is getting worse and worse. · 4) Trains are not nearly as polluting as planes. / Trains are much less polluting than planes. · 5) We must raise awareness of the water shortage. / We must raise awareness about the water shortage.

Week 12 · Personal Goals

	Answers
Exercise 1	1) to lock · 2) seeing · 3) to buy · 4) drinking · 5) drinking · 6) to lift
Exercise 2	1) not accepting · 2) to inform · 3) to track · 4) feeling · 5) explaining · 6) to become
Exercise 3	1) b · 2) a · 3) a · 4) b · 5) a · 6) b
Exercise 4	1) I stopped (gave up) smoking two years ago. · 2) Remember to set realistic goals. / Don't forget to set realistic goals. · 3) I regret not studying harder. / I regret not having studied harder. · 4) I tried to get up early, but I was too tired. / I tried to wake up early, but I was very tired. · 5) I'll never forget seeing the pyramids for the first time. / I'll never forget seeing the Pyramids for the first time.

Final Check · Weeks 9–12

	Answers
A	1) Despite / In spite of · 2) in · 3) whereas / while · 4) down · 5) to seeing · 6) the · 7) much · 8) nearly · 9) smoking · 10) to send
B	1) Although he was tired, he went to work. / Despite being tired, he went to work. / In spite of being tired, he went to work. · 2) They put the meeting off (put off the meeting) until Sunday. · 3) Life in the city is much (far) more expensive than life in the village. · 4) I regret not learning to swim. / I regret not having learnt to swim. · 5) I came across an old photo of my grandfather. / I came across an old picture of my grandfather.

	Answers
C	1) امتحان تجريبي · 2) مشوّق جدًا · 3) حريق غابات · 4) الانضباط الذاتي · 5) بينما / في حين أن